Doxa

Sermon series transcript

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Part 1

The Authority to Redefine Reality

And there is no bad news. Unless you don't like Doxa becoming a series, go to the book of 2 Corinthians chapter 3 verse 7. The title of today's message is the authority to redefine reality. The authority to redefine reality. You guys ready? You sure? Did you like doxa last week? Are you glad that it's a series? Okay, it's a big deal. Ready? 2 Corinthians 3. This is review from last week. The rest of this will not be review, but this is one of the clearest pictures that it paints for us. It says, "If the ministry of death written and engraved on stones was glorious, so that the children of Israel could not look steadily at the face of Moses because of the glory of his countenance, which glory was passing away, how will the ministry of the spirit not be more glorious?

For if the ministry of condemnation had glory, the ministry of righteousness exceeds much more in glory. For even what was made glorious had no glory in this respect because of the glory that excels. For if what was passing away was glorious, what remains is much more glorious. Therefore, since we have such hope, we use great boldness of speech. Unlike Moses who put a veil over his face so that the children of Israel could not look steadily at the end of what was passing away. But their minds were blinded. For until this day the same veil remains unlifted in the reading of the Old Testament because the veil is taken away in Christ. Holy smokes. And where the spirit of the Lord is, there is liberty.

But we all with unveiled face behold as in a mirror the glory of the Lord are being transformed into the same image from glory to glory just as by the spirit of the Lord. I'm going to pray for you then we'll get rocking. All right. Father, thank you so much for this remarkable group of human beings. I ask right now that this revelatory word bring us to the measure of the stature of the fullness of Christ. Holy Spirit, you're Lord of this place. Angels, you are free to minister. free to defend, free to swing swords, free to deliver, free to heal. I'm going to preach. You do the heavy lifting. Father, we thank you that this place is an open heaven. We thank you that the nations are our inheritance. And we thank you that this city is the blueprint for heaven on earth. In Jesus name, everybody said, "Amen." Okay, first let's open with scandal. Scandal gets attention, right?

Exegesis and the veil

Let's open with scandal. When you and I read this passage, it is fitting for us to hear something like the same veil remains unlifted in the reading of the Old Testament because you and I have this book that conveniently has two parts. Right? So when we hear that there's a veil when you

read the Old Testament, we're like, "Oh, well, I'll just read this part." Okay, this is a big deal. They didn't have this part. They're actively writing this part. So the voice of God through an apostolic leader was saying, "I'm trying to get you away from the book scandal, right? There are two things that happen when you interpret scripture. One of them is called exegesis. Exegesis is when you properly extrapolate from the text its original meaning.

You do that through asking proper questions. Who wrote this? Who'd they write it to? When did they write it? Where did they write it? Those things matter, right? Because right here when we crack a can open, it is pop, right? My Arkansan daughter-in-law over there is like ready to throw down because she teaches her kids to ask for sodas at Mimi and Pap's house. And we're like, we don't know what those are, right? So, geography matters, time matters, audience matters. So, if this guy is saying, listen, there's a veil when you read the Old Testament. There was no New Testament as an alternative. What he's saying was when you read your book, there's a veil on your heart. And the only way that veil can go away is if you stop reading the Old Testament and start looking at the incarnate word.

Come on. Yes. Yeah. Yep. So now we're able to understand what those two glories are. By the way, for anyone listening to me for the first time, this thing is like my tenth because I beat them up. I love it. Okay? So don't think that I'm anti-Bible. I'm not. I love this thing. It smells good. It looks good. It tastes good. I mean, you got to try everything. You know, so I'm not anti-book, but what I am saying is if you were in the Corinthian church and Paul is clearly confronting something that is identity based and he says, listen, if you keep reading that, you'll never see who you are. When Moses set the laws beside the ark of the covenant, your Bible, our Bible says that he set them there as a witness against the nation of Israel.

How could you miss it? Those things are there to condemn you. And if you continue to read systems that condemn you, you'll never see yourself. So, you need to be transformed from glory to glory. the glory of a book that was meant to condemn you to the glory of the word that was meant to reveal you. It's one transition from death to life, lost to found book to the government of the spirit. You with me?

Law, Adam, and judgment

The authority to redefine reality. There is a reality captured in the pages of the Old Testament. When Paul talks about that reality, he refers to it as the ministry of death and the ministry of condemnation. When he talks about what it does in the beginning of the book of Romans, he says it condemns everyone. It confines everyone to sin. And get this, it arouses your sin nature. It doesn't cure Adam. It exposes Adam and it expands Adam. The law made Adam worse. The law created Adam in the first place. You understand what I'm saying? Right? Adam would not

have been a problem had Adam not tried to follow a law. Add more laws, get more Adam. Right? There's a reason there's a reason that the Bible says that the gospel is foolishness to those who are perishing.

If Adam's eyes try to look upon freedom, it sees freedom as something to be apprehended rather than something to receive, something to earn rather than something that you intrinsically already possess. So you can add as many behavior modifications to Adam as you would like. It doesn't fix him. It exposes him. Right? Do you want to hear a funny story? You guys familiar with the uh the golden calf? Yeah. Yeah. Do you know what it was made out of? Stolen jewelry. Yeah. Yep. Do you know what Aaron said when Moses came down the mountain? He's like, "Where'd that come from?" Got me, bro. Like, Yep. Don't worship false idols. Don't lie. Don't steal. Right before the law even came down off the mountain, they were already in progress.

Right? It wasn't there beforehand. It didn't happen before that. The law aroused Adam's nature. So the more you try to modify your behaviors, the more the opinion of that system redefines you. You with me? Okay. Do you want to understand how a human works? 'Cause humans don't work the way you think they work. I have a brother. His name is Tyler. And Tyler was a fantastic wrestler in high school. And our senior year he was wrestling 112, 119 and I was 250. 250. Yeah. Yep. And I had like my whole life I'm asking this these questions like I train, I diet, I have muffin tops. This kid does whatever he wants. He's strolling around with a six-pack all the time. Then I realized that if you have an issue with food, then food becomes a law.

And if you look at most of the punishment in the New Testament after the law, we think God changed his character. God did not change his character. Humanity became judge, jury, and executioner. So when somebody breaks the law, they take him outside the city gate and they stone him to death. And then they say, "God made it happen. Snakes come in and invade your village and like that was that's because we picked up sticks on Sunday. We knew we shouldn't have picked up sticks on Sunday, right? No, they just start seeing God through poor covenant. They start seeing him through a bad glory. So when you grow up with a skinny brother and you're the chubby kid and you see him eat whatever he wants and you're like, so you take the cake and the moment you take the cake, you're trying to earn health, right?

As a matter of fact, let me put it this way. The moment you take the steak, you're trying to earn health. The moment you take the cake, you realize that you're breaking the law. Your body will punish yourself for it. Guess what? It punishes itself with muffin tops. Yeah. My whole life, listen, I'm I'm I'm trying to battle this thing and it's like, oh, you're ectomorph, you're mesomorph, you're endomorph. I don't think that's it. I think I created a law for myself. My consciousness is self-imposing judgment on me and now every time I break my diet, I deserve

punished. Yep. I deserve punishment. So what we see happen here is that if you continue to read this thing, it's death and condemnation because you heap death and condemnation on yourself, right?

How many laws did Adam and Eve have? Yeah. Ironically, it was don't live by the law, right? Don't eat of the tree of the knowledge of good and evil. Why? Because that's the thing that you participate in to become something you already are. That's what legalism does, right? And then what happens? They hear God coming, so they run. Why they run? Because God's angry? No. Self-imposed judgment, right? The naked bodies that God created in his own image were God's capstone to creation. Now they're hiding them from him because they're mis-seeing him according to their own condemnation. That's what one law did. What do you think 613 does when you read the Old Testament? Yeah. Do you know? Do you know your your t-shirt today qualifies you for execution under the old covenant?

These beard, can you believe this? These beard lines qualify me for execution. I need to provide a sacrifice for having god-like beard lines. Yeah. You're not supposed to trim the corners of your beard. I don't even know what that means. Yeah. That's why rabbis are all round dead, right? Do you understand how this works? So, when Paul's when Paul's saying this, it's important to recognize that he's in Corinth in the first century and saying, "Listen, until this day when Moses is read, there's a veil on your heart." Meaning, if you keep living by that, you'll never see him. If you keep trying to behave your way out of Adam, you can never step into Christ because Christ is received. Adam's earned. Adam gives you an earned identity. Christ gives you an assigned one. Get it?

Defining Doxa

Okay. So, the Greek word doxa, you don't have to look very far for this. It is the first like four definitions in the Strong's concordance which we know is an accompaniment, an extra biblical accompaniment to the King James version. So often times they will rewrite their definitions to frame up their theology. This is one that thankfully they missed. Now they added a few definitions that aren't the real definitions of a first century Greek. But if you say the word doxa to a first century Greek, they will hear estimate, opinion, or judgment. So when it says that the old covenant had glory, it's not saying that it was shining. It was saying that it had something to say. And what it had to say was death and condemnation.

Moses came down off the mountain with a veil over his face, not because it was beautiful, because it was death and condemnation. Nobody wanted to see what he had to offer. That's why legalists have to scare you with evangelism rather than invite you into relationship. Get it? So there there cannot be a world where Jesus exists, gets transfigured on the mountain, comes

down off the mountain, then cities start swarming to him. And if we think that he wasn't shining as radiantly as Moses was, we have something else to learn. Moses was not unappealing to the children of Israel because he was too glorious. He was unappealing to the children of Israel because his face shone with death and condemnation from the law that had just been delivered.

Jesus hears these words. It's my son. I like him. Right? Think of this. It's my kid. I like him and that's enough. Yep. As a matter of fact, there's so many parts to this. This is my beloved son in whom I'm well pleased. Right? You you again proper exegesis. You need to make sure that you're reading this in the components that they're presented because it's easy to believe that you're his beloved. It's hard to believe that he's pleased with you. Yeah. Sometimes love is an obligation. How many of you love your kids? How many of you like them? You know, that's different. I They're not both in the room, are they? Yeah. So, I always like to say I really like one of them and then I never Yeah.

Yeah. Yeah. Yeah. Yep. So they just have to talk about that afterwards to figure out who it is. Y'all good? Okay. So if you keep reading that, you'll never find yourself. Stop reading, start looking, and you'll be transformed into the thing that you're beholding. And you don't go from glory to glory to glory to glory to glory in some endless theological graduation system. It's out of the glory of death and condemnation into the glory of the beloved son. Then you're done. Thank you, Lord. Then you're done. There's a reason. How many of you are familiar with this journey that the children of Israel took out of Egypt and into the promised land? Do you know how long it took? Careful. 80 years. They went twice.

They got there in 40, saw some giants, were like, "Y'all scary." Went back out, circled around some more, and then came back later with Caleb and Joshua as their leader. Do you know how long it took to get from Egypt to the promised land? 19 days. It was a trip right across the top of the wilderness called the way of the Philistine. They could have been there in 20 days, but they didn't. Jesus goes to the wilderness though and he shows you that you can go from hanging with the devil in the garden to being transfigured on a mountain like that. Don't have to waste 40 years on your wilderness journey because he took it for you. He overcome overcame everything that you'd ever face in it.

And then he brought you into his transfiguration without the voice of the law and a prophet. You realize that's what was happening on the on the mountain 'cause Moses and Elijah showed up and Peter wanted to build three tents. And in the middle of him saying, "Hey, let's build three tents." God's like, "Sh, just one's fine. This is my kid. Listen to him." Why does he have to listen to him? Because Moses kills you. Jesus is the fulfillment of the law and the prophets. Good. Yes. Okay. You want to be done? Of course not.

John's revelatory content

Okay. Doxa comes from the Greek word dokeō which means to think, suppose, seem, appear, consider, or form an opinion of. Doxa was an opinion, a judgment, a reputation or what someone or something is thought to be. Do you hear anything about fog machines or glitter or clouds or anything that we think of when we say the word glory? Right. So the Bible I just I just want if Greeks could see us now. The way that we define holy, right? When when somebody asks you to act holy, what are they saying? Or be holy? Perfect. Right? So, imagine that holiness is behavioral perfection and then angels are actually singing in English around the throne and they're going, "Behave, behave, behave." Right? It's not that It's not that cool.

It's not that cool. It's also not cool in the US to shout glory because we're saying opinion. Yeah. Greeks would be super confused by our willingness to adopt words that we don't understand, then yell them at inappropriate Christian times. Yep. They just wouldn't get it. So, doxa, glory, it's used all throughout your New Testament. And in your New Testament, it's nearly always talking about the same thing. Classic Greek writers use this term to define public opinions, personal reputation, someone's estimation of a thing, or a consensus regarding a person. That's just what it means. Okay. So, in John 1, we're actually going to stay in John for the rest of the message, I think. In John 1, we have to recognize that John is the first New Testament writer to write revelatory content.

Matthew, Mark, Luke wrote historical content. They recorded either their eyewitness account or Jesus verbatim. John is the first guy that opens his book by saying, "In the beginning was the word. The word was with God and the word was God and the word became flesh." Right? So the other gospel writers would have been like, "Whoa, he never said that." and he didn't. But John got it by revelation. So what you continue to see throughout the book of John is John doing a compare and contrast of the glory of the Old Testament with the glory that we behold in Jesus. It happens in nearly every chapter. In nearly every chapter. So when it talks about Jesus in John 1 and it says we beheld his glory, it's not talking about Jesus showing up in a glowing robe.

We literally get to see God's opinion of somebody that's fully human walking in flesh in front of us. Somebody that hasn't been tainted by an Adamic lineage. Some somebody that hasn't started to strive try to strive to become remember we were just talking about the nutrition thing. The very system that you build to fix it is the system that kills you. Right? So eat the cake, condemned by the cake, punish myself for the cake, get the muffin tops. Yep. Same thing happened in the garden. I'm not like God. I want to become like God. I'll reach out to become like God. And in reaching out, I prove that I'm not like him. Yep. I prove that I'm not like him. So, it is the reach that is the confession.

Get it? It's the reach that is the confession. So Jesus comes fully confident in, this is so good because you're going to see it repeated over and over and over in the book of John, fully confident in the father's glory of him. And because he's fully confident in the father's glory of him, he becomes manipulation-proof in religious crowds. Yeah. Imagine this. Imagine being in front of hundreds, maybe thousands of people that disagree with you completely and standing your ground because one person agrees with you. Yeah. Makes you manipulation proof, right? Well, you got to do this to be part of our club. Wait, no. And then they get mad at him. He says, "Your witness isn't true. You you you bear witness of yourself." He's like, "Actually, no, I don't.

I and the father are one. We get two votes. Your law says that whatever I say has to be confirmed by two to three witnesses. I've got two. Done deal. Thousand religious people are there telling him he's not enough. Do you know what? John chapter 5. You don't have to turn here, but John chapter 5. You know the initial reason why they sought to kill Jesus was the word pater. First time the the the first time the word pater was used in the entire biblical narrative and it is not religious. It is not reverent. It's like if a salesman comes to your door and you say, "I'm sorry, dad's not home right now." The word dad in Greek is pater where we get patristic and where we get the English word father.

So in John 5 it says, "They sought to kill him all the more because he called God Father," claiming equality with God. Right? If you want religious people to come after you, there's a blueprint. Yep. Call God Dad. So John 5, they sought to kill him all the more. So the the initial reason for the execution demand on Jesus's life wasn't because he was uprooting the system. It's because his relationship with the creator of the universe was too good to be true. It was familiar. So the reason that he was able to withstand the constant criticism of his ministry and finish his race is because the doxa of men was not the doxa that he was counting on for a definition of himself. Get it? Okay. The doxa of his father is what defined him, which made him able to selflessly love the people that wanted to kill him and kept him from conforming and becoming anything that he wasn't before the foundation of the world. Good so far?

The Logos and the light

Okay. So, let's talk about this real quick. The word logos. You guys know that word. In the beginning was the word. The word was with God and the word was God. He was in the beginning with God and all things were made through him. Without him nothing was made that was made. In him was life. That life was the light of men. So we we talked about this before. John is the first one to give us revelation uh and insight into these things. And one of the reason that he gives this revelation is because he's actually combating Greek philosophy. Logos isn't a Christian term. Logos was a term that came from a guy named Heraclitus. It's

about 300 years prior to this. And Heraclitus posited that there was something called logos that essentially was the record of the written universe.

It's not God. It's unknowable and it's unconcerned. The only thing you can do is get aligned with it or stay out of it. It's it's the thought process that follows us into new age. When people say like, "I'm trying to align myself with the universe." Some somehow someway there's some type of favor that comes with accidentally stumbling into what Logos has for you. Okay? So, they were close. But the reason John starts his letter the way he starts it is because he's he's refuting Greek philosophers and simultaneously using language that they'll understand. So, they would have said he would have said in the beginning was the logos, right? And beginning again we have to define this beginning means origin archetype or a concept that is entirely apart from time not the beginning chronologically the beginning foundationally so somebody that would have been in Greek philosophy would have said yeah absolutely that's exactly what the logos is in the beginning in the archē was the logos and the logos was with God they might have bought that and the the logos was God.

He was in the beginning with God. All things were made through him. Without him nothing was made that was made. In him was life and that life was the light of men. So John was directly confronting the philosophical view of creation with the in introduction of the incarnate word. Heraclitus. This is how he defined logos. The divine record or discourse that governs and coordinates creation. So when John moves in to the part of his letter that says, "And the logos put on flesh and dwelt among us," that's when a philosopher would have been like, "Wait a minute." They would have been extremely offended. Thing I like about some of these early letters is they were snarky before snark was cool. Yeah. He like drags you in.

He's like, "Yeah, in the beginning was the logos." You're like, "Yeah." And the logos was God. Yeah. And he put on flesh and came and hung out. Wait a minute. Yeah. So that's that's what he's trying to to to to to put in front of you, right? And this is this is why the title is the authority to redefine reality. So Jesus doesn't come to fix a system. Jesus comes to introduce a new one completely apart from senses and experience. So when he comes and it says we beheld his glory, it's not talking about his robe lighting up. It's literally saying that God finally gets to have his opinion made known to humans through a human, right? Which has never happened before 4,000 years without the thoughts of God being made manifest in creation outside of God himself putting on human flesh and then us beholding God's opinion.

It's a big deal, right? Because it takes us straight back to Genesis. God says they're very good. Then a serpent comes up and says, "I don't think you're very good. You might be one step away from very good. If you grab that and eat it, then you'll be very good." What do we have competing right now for our conscience? Two doxas. Yes. Two doxas. What if the whole

story's been about two doxas the entire time? And then the moment that Adam and Eve separate themselves from the doxa of God, their self-imposed separation keeps them from knowing his thoughts. So now they're just being constantly fed a narrative that's stuck in a feedback loop that they themselves are creating, right? They're creating it because God sewed into creation.

Creation's obedience to submit itself to the expectations of humanity. Now humanity is believing a different logos. So creation gets subject to humanity's frustration. So every time humanity has a poor opinion of themselves, they can find proof that it's true. Get me? This is why, listen, people die. Not joking. This is why people die because your brain is literally trained to detect and prove the opinion that you already have. Yes, that's right. Yep. If you think you're a victim, you'll find proof. You can bypass a hundred blessings to find proof that goes along with your doxa and then say, "I told you so." Right? Your threat detection system is constantly trying to keep you alive and it thinks because you're detecting so many threats that dying might actually be safer for you.

So it ushers you into a safe grave. With me so far? Yes. That's why they call it the cycle of sin and death. Yeah. righteousness and life. Yep. Good stuff, right? So, in John, when Jesus shows up, God, you need to read your Bible. No one has seen God at any time. Right? That means Joshua didn't see God. Ruth didn't see God. Samuel didn't see God. These kings didn't see God. Ezra didn't see God. Nehemiah didn't see God. Esther didn't see God. Job didn't see God. David didn't see God. Solomon didn't see God. Isaiah didn't see God. Jeremiah didn't see God. Daniel didn't see God. Yep. Estimates, best estimates. But there's one that's come down from the bosom of the Father, and he has declared him, and in him we have beheld his glory. Amen. Right. Get it? This is good news. Yes.

The witness of the Father

So what John is trying to say, I'm not getting very far. Promise I will. What John is trying to say that there is something that defines reality, but sorry Heraclitus, it's not your logos. It is word. It is the creation of the entire universe that literally created the universe from and of himself. Yep. So he doesn't just get to define it. He is it. So it can't contradict who he is. Right? It's either in Christ created from the fabric of divinity or wrong. Good. Okay. You want to venture through John a little bit with me? All right. 600 BC. Heraclitus, the universe, something apart from all things that governed all things. Greek wouldn't have attributed this to an unknowable. Excuse me. The Greeks would have attributed this term to an unknowable impersonal impersonal fatelike pattern that no one can know or understand.

So when John is like he's right there, Greeks would have been very upset. Here's a quote. Although this logos is eternally valid, men were unable to understand it. not only before hearing it but after they have heard it for the first time. That is to say, although all things come to pass in accordance with this logos, men seem to be quite without any experience of it. At least they are judged in light of such words and deeds as I am here setting forth. We should let ourselves be guided by what is common to all. Yet, although the logos is common to all, most men live as if each of them had a private intelligence of its own. This is Greek. This isn't Bible. So what I'm saying is they knew that something outside of time created everything inside of time, but it was unknowable, unconcerned, and impersonal.

So John's saying, "Yeah, um I know it. I know it." So rather than stumbling into the universe's plan with you, you actually get to be in the one that created the universe. Much better news. You ready? Okay. John 1. Don't have to go here. John 1:14, "The word became flesh and dwelt among us, and we beheld his glory, the glory as of the only begotten of the father, full of grace and truth." Ready? Okay. Only begotten of the father. Jesus is an only child. Adam's not God's kid. Adam's an illusion. only begotten. The the Greek word is monogenēs, meaning only one being on the entire planet is God's biological child. He doesn't have a second son. You're not a second son. The Bible says you're counted as the seed.

So, you're in the firstborn, right? Only begotten. this. Oh, wait. Yeah. Yeah. Yeah. John bore witness of him and cried out, "This was he of whom I said, "He who comes after me is preferred before me, and he was before me, and of the fullness we have all received, grace for grace." Ready? For the law was given through Moses. But grace and truth came through Jesus Christ. No one has seen God at any time. The only begotten son who is in the bosom of the father. He's declared him. Grace and truth came through Jesus. Which means truth didn't come through Moses. So stop mistaking the thing that was meant to disqualify you as true. Right? Not making it up. It's right here. John 1, introduction to understanding revelatory things.

The law came through Moses. Jesus constantly confronted us. He says, "You read Moses thinking that you'll find life. There's one that condemns you, Moses." And then we're like reading the devotional of Ezekiel thinking we're going to snap out of it. Okay. The only record, account, or discourse that accurately represents the pattern for all things stepped into human flesh and declared that which governs and established the order and nature of all things. Not philosophy, not religion, the creator of the universe himself. Moses wrote the Genesis record, but no one has seen God at any time. That means Moses could not see what God caused. Excuse me. Moses could see what God caused, but didn't fully discern word himself. Good. Okay. You ready for this? John 5.

I'm not super old school, but I love to hear your pages turning. John 5. Everybody there? Where do you want to start? Verse 31. If I bear witness of myself, my witness is not true. Fair enough, right? Okay. This might be one of the most empowering statements that you will ever read because if your opinion is different than your father's, it's wrong. Yeah. Yep. Once you read that, you realize that he actually tried to say this quite a few times. Yep. He tried to say this quite a few times. If our heart condemns us, be of good cheer. He's greater than our heart. Yep. So even if you're self-condemned, doesn't make you wrong. Excuse me. It doesn't make you less. It does make you wrong.

Yeah. If our heart condemns us, be of good cheer. He's greater than our heart. Yep. Good. So if I bear witness of myself, my witness is not true. There is another who bears witness of me. I know that the witness which he witnesses of me is true. You have sent to John and he has borne witness to the truth. Can we talk about John for a minute? Oh, can we talk about John for a minute? By the way, this is John writing, so he's clearly not talking about himself. John the Baptist. Imagine trusting. Listen, imagine Jesus trusting John the Baptist for his identity. John the Baptist was Jesus's forerunner, right? Jesus said on numerous occasions, "John bore witness of me, but he's not the witness."

Do you know why? Because the second John got put in jail, he sent two of his disciples to Jesus and said, "Ask him if he's the Messiah or if we're waiting on somebody better. Yeah. So, even if you have a current fan, putting your eggs in that basket, sometimes in Jesus's own narrative can lead to massive disappointment. When people approve of you, they're not actually approving of you. They're approving of the fact that you affirm their value. Yep. If people disapprove of you, they're not disapproving of you. They're disapproving of the fact that you're confronting their value. So both applause and criticism are unstable sources. Yeah. So John is literally the one that bore witness of the one that's greater. He said, 'I'm not even worthy to tie your shoes until he falls upon hard times.

And all of a sudden, he's like, "Hey, go ask Jesus if he's really the Messiah or if we're waiting on a better one." Yeah, that's that's not a real question. That's a rhetorical question that shows everybody how ticked off he is. Yeah. Good. Ready for this? You have you have sent to John, and he has borne witness to the truth. But I don't receive testimony from man, but I say these things that you may be saved. He was the burning and shining lamp, and you were willing for the time to rejoice in his light. But I have a greater witness than John's. For the works which the Father has given me to finish, the very works that I do bear witness of me, that the Father has sent me. and the Father himself who sent me, he testified of me.

You have neither heard his voice at any time nor seen his form, but you do not have his word abiding in you because whom he sent him you do not believe. You search the scriptures.

Ready? For in them you think you'll have eternal life. And these are they which testify of me. But you're not willing to come to me that you might have life. I don't receive honor from men. Okay, pop quiz. What do you think the Greek word that we translated into honor here is? It's doxa. Wow. It's doxa again. And how like biblical translators to confuse us. It's like glory, glory, glory, glory, honor. Yeah. But you got to make it fit your narrative, right? So what's he saying? It doesn't even matter to me what John said.

I don't receive doxa from men. Right? And listen, we we can isolate this to make it kind of self-serving, but it's not that he's saying eternally forever apart from time and space. Not one thing that I have experienced through senses and time am I going to allow to doxa me. You search the scriptures. You think you have life in them because they are excuse me uh and these are they which testify of me, but you're not willing to come to me that you might have life. I don't receive honor from men, but I know you that you do not have the love of God in you. Ready? I have come in my father's name and you do not receive me. If another comes in his own name, you'll receive him.

How can you believe who receive honor from one another and do not seek the honor which comes from the only God. Do not, man, listen. Do not think that I shall accuse you to the father. There's one that accuses you, Moses, in whom you trust. Yeah. For if you believed Moses, you would believe me, for he wrote about me. But if you did not believe his writings, how will you believe my words. So, do you understand what's what's going down here? Same thing that's going down through the whole biblical narrative. Yep. The incarnate word is coming to redefine reality for you. Yep. You can't change the story. You can't modify the behaviors. You have to adopt a new existence that comes from a brand new resource from which no human has ever seen.

Yeah. Good news. So what's he saying? He says that you receive honor from one another and that's your problem. Yep. That's your problem. If you receive honor from one another, but you won't receive the honor that comes from the only God, how will you ever know who I am? Right. Yeah. Listen, this happens all through. Do you know what just happened before this passage? Jesus is in his hometown teaching the word. Guess where it can't happen? Because he's in his hometown. Yeah. No miracles, right? No mighty miracles among them because they became too familiar. Do you know what familiar means? Yeah. They they didn't say bad things about him. They said, "I know his mom and dad." That's what cost them the divine impartation available from the creator of the universe is because they saw him according to human opinion. Different doxa. That's it. Good. You sure? This should have been a couple sermons.

Praise of men vs. God

Go to John 8. Skip that one. We'll do that next week. Go to John 12. Start in verse 37. Everybody there? But although he had done so many signs before him, they did not believe that the word of Isaiah, which the prophet, excuse me, the word Isaiah the prophet might be fulfilled, which he spoke, Lord, who has believed our report. To whom has the arm of the Lord been revealed. Therefore, they could not believe because Isaiah said again, "He has blinded their eyes, hardened their hearts, lest they should see with their eyes lest they should understand with their hearts and turn, so that I should heal them. These things Isaiah said when he saw his glory and spoke of him. Ready? Nevertheless, even among the rulers, many believed in him, but because of the Pharisees, they did not confess him, lest they be put out of the synagogue, for they loved the praise of men more than the praise of God.

Question for you, pop quiz. What Greek word do you think they translated into the word praise? Doxa. You got it. Yeah. So why were Pharisees not okay with people that believed in the one and only begotten son of the father? Ha. They loved the doxa of men more than the doxa of God. Then Jesus cried out and said, "He who believes in me believes not in me but in him who sent me. And he who sees me sees him who sent me. I have I have come as a light into the world. And whoever believes in me should not abide in darkness. If anyone hears my words and does not believe, I do not judge him. We have to cancel like 400 years of ministry.

Ready? For I did not come to judge the world, but to save it. He who rejects me and does not receive my words has that which judges him. The word that I have spoken will judge him in the last day. Now, sound like a threat. It's not a threat. It's a promise. It's a good one. That means my estimate will have the final say. Yep. It's what it says. Yeah. When you read stuff like this and there's just seeming contradiction all through it, like I didn't come to judge, but I'm going to judge. No, he has that which judges him. Do you know what judges him? The other glory. the other glory. If you don't believe me, then you have the thing that's going to judge you.

He doesn't have to do a thing. He proved that at in John 8, the thing we skipped when he catches the woman in adultery, right? There's men standing there. He's like, if you're without sin, cast the first stone and they walk out. Why? It says because they were convicted by their conscience. They walked away from the creator of the universe because they judge themselves. If you don't believe the word of God, you have the thing that's going to judge you already. It's your own opinion of yourself. Ready? I have come as a light into the world. Whoever believes in me should not abide in darkness. If anyone hears my words and doesn't believe him, I don't judge him. I didn't come to judge the world.

I came to save the world. He who rejects me does not and and does not receive my words has that which judges him. Right? The word that I have spoken will judge him in the last day.

Right? Don't worry, we'll get there. Is what he's saying. For I have not spoken on my own authority, but the Father who sent me gave me a command that what I should say and what I should speak, and I know that his command is everlasting life. Therefore, whatever I speak, just as the Father has told me, so I speak. Good. I feel like we need to go back just just for a second. Okay. Jesus cried out. Okay. Could you imagine? Do you know why Jesus cries out? usually because of the thing that it talks about right before him.

Right? So nevertheless, even among the rulers, many believed in him, but because of the Pharisees, they did not confess him, lest they should be put out of the synagogue. Imagine this. These are religious men that believe in Jesus that don't want to say they believe in Jesus because they've spent their entire life earning, striving, trying, and deserving. And they've gotten to a place where what they've done has gained them some credibility. And they're about to have their medals that they've earned stripped to be given one that somebody else earned for them. Makes you look kind of silly. Yep. They wouldn't confess them. So Jesus yells. He's like, "Listen, you love the doxa of men more than the doxa that comes from the only God. You would rather earn your way to righteousness than receive righteousness as a free gift.

You'd rather earn your way to righteousness, then receive righteousness as a free gift. Why do you think Nicodemus came to Jesus under the guise of nighttime? Yeah. So he wouldn't be judged because everything that he had earned didn't compare with the free gift that he saw in Jesus and his disciples life. He's like, "What do I have to do to get what you're packing?" Yep. And what did Jesus say? New dad, man. You need a new dad. Yep. New doxa, new opinion, new lineage, new history, an existence outside of time that redefines reality for you. Partnership with the one who has authority to redefine reality. A doxa that doesn't breed death and condemnation. Good. There's going to be a doxa week three. It's going to be a doxa week three.

Practical confession and prayer

Listen, would you guys stand with me just for a moment? How was this? Yeah. I want it to be practical. That's why you're standing. Uh, one of the the really really important things that the church maybe the word I don't want to blame anything the church has has done is we sometimes don't like to confess what we what we actually believe. When we were buying the building, Chris Blackaby, he uh he said, "You have to say something out loud." I said, "What is it?" He said, "You have to say, 'I hate faith." Why would I say that? He said, ' Because it's true. and if you say it, then you can deal with it." And I'm like, "Why do you think I hate faith?" He's like, "Because you'd rather have a bank account with a million dollars in it than believe that God will give you everything that you want."

I'm like, "Dang, you right, man." Yeah. Yeah. Yep. He got me. Yeah. He's like, "Okay, so say it." I was like, "I hate faith. God, I hate faith." Yep. He's like, "Okay, now you can deal with it." Right? So the word of faith movement taught you to deny the thing that you actually believe and then just become this confessing idiot, right? Confession was never the end. Confession was the beginning and confession was supposed to lead to manifestation. And it can't unless you tell yourself, listen, I value the praise of men more than the praise of God. It's just true. I hate it, but it's true. Yes, criticism destroys me. Yes, praise makes me go further and longer and harder. I love the doxa of men.

And if I would just receive the doxa that comes from the only God, then I could be free to serve humanity whether they applaud or criticize. Yep. I could be free to step into the identity that he has for me apart from the creation of the world without being infiltrated by Moses, the one that tries to define me based on what I've done, where I've been, who I did it with, who I did it to. Yeah. I have the opportunity now to come out of this is what I love. One glory, one doxa that encompasses everything that ever defined me according to time and space. and then be transformed into the very image by beholding the face of the Lord in a mirror. As it's important as in a mirror.

When you look at that mirror, you do not see your reflection. You see him. He's your reflection. And then you get transformed into the very image from doxa to doxa. Right? So right now deal with yourself. I'll pray, but while I pray, deal with yourself. You want one of the things like the sacred biology led me to, I was a confessing idiot, right? I'm healthy in Jesus name. I'm whole in Jesus name. I have the 120 over 80 blood pressure in Jesus name. I didn't. It was 186 over 135. Right? And the confession's good, but if I'm not like, listen, I feel 85 when I wake up and that's not okay. Right? It's okay to say that. It's not okay. And then you sit there, you're like, "This hurts.

I have pain in my right knee, left hip, low back, right side of my traps." And that is not okay. Me saying that doesn't make it real. Me saying that gives truth somewhere to land because truth is more important than facts, so good, right? Yes. So you can say it. You can say, "I love the praise of men." Even if you don't love the praise of men, you put way more value in it. You put way more value in it than you do the doxa of the only God. I'm going to pray while I pray. You deal with yourself. Father, thank you so much for these beautiful, beautiful humans. Thank you for the revelation of the doxa of God. Thank you that there's an opinion of us that is from apart from the foundation of the world. that we exist in you apart from time and space that senses and experience and encounters and earnings striving trying and deserving none of those things determine who we are.

You said even if our heart condemns us be of good cheer. You're better than that. The condemnation that we've heaped upon ourselves does not make your truth less real. So right now, Father, we deal with ourselves and we're asking that you show us, show us the invisible ceilings where we've allowed the opinions of Adam to creep in and limit us. We confess right now that we are not not enough and we are not too much. We're everything you are and nothing that you're not. You alone have the authority to redefine reality, Father. And we partner with your doxa. Our conscience has been cleansed by the appearing of a better word. And right now, Father, put your hands up. This is this is what you'll receive right now. Father, we receive being known as we're known. Not known as we think. Right now we say every man be a liar. Let God be true and every man be a liar. And father right now we receive an impartation. We see it as a matter of fact experientially right now to be known as we are known in Jesus name.

Part 2

Defining Glory and Identity

Make sure that we know that semantic saturation is a real problem in biblical interpretation. That was all the big words I know for the day. Semantic saturation is where you use a word so much that you forget what it means. It just becomes rote to you. Like literally rote to you. Did I use it right or did I use it wrong? Do you love pizza? Might be a better a better estimate. Love by its definition is the ability to suffer for someone else. Would you suffer for pizza? God, I hope not. The Greek word agape is where we get our word agony which we translate into the word love.

The kind of love that the father has for the son. The kind of love that the son has for us. Agony literally others-focused, other-centered self-sacrificing love. So we use words all the time in the Christian church and have no idea what they mean. Don't we brother? Yep. When I call you brother, I'm confessing that you and I are from the same seed. Right? So it's not just we go to the same church, we get to fist bump on Sundays or when we see ourselves out or see each other out in public. I'm literally confessing that you and I have both been raised by the same father. So now I'm confessing our heritage when I call you brother. But we've become so commonplace and using words that we don't understand that we could carry an entire conversation with no definitions and not need them at all.

Right? Hallelujah. Which thankfully Shanda defined for us. And what's odd is it doesn't matter what language you say that word in means the same thing. It's good, right? Glory. Glory. Glory. Yeah. Yep. So the word doxa in the Greek language is the one that we translate to the word glory in the English language. And we have associated that word with some kind of spiritual but non-explainable manifestation. And if I say the word glory, you picture like maybe sweet lights, fog machine, goosebumps. But the reason I can't define it is because we can't define it. And we might even say something like, "Oh, I feel the glory of God upon me." Or, "I see the glory of God upon you." But if we were first century Hellenistic Greeks, we would realize that it's a really important saying, but it doesn't mean what you think it means.

The Greek word doxa in the in in in that original language, in that setting, meant judgment, estimate, opinion, or reputation. And without a subject to reference, we actually have no idea if it's a good word or a bad word. You have no idea, right? So, you might bear the doxa of your alcoholic father. Listen, you might bear the glory of your alcoholic father and not realize that that has defined you. That has been the judgment estimate reputation that you've borne because you thought glory was a good thing. You didn't realize the gospel in its essence is Jesus

coming with the glory of the father. Right? Not the goosebumps of the father, not the light show of the father, the opinion of the father through which he in his incarnation bears witness to the father and you simultaneously.

Right? So when John's talking about Jesus's incarnation, he says, "And the word became flesh and we beheld his glory." Right? And that is not a churchy word. If somebody in the first century would say, "I beheld God's glory." That would have been like, "Oh, wow. What was it like?" Not like fall to the face. It's not what it meant. Not in Greek. So if we want to understand doxa, we need to reread all of these passages, which I think we've done a good job the last few weeks kind of breaking those things up in John 5, John 1, 2 Corinthians 3. 2 Corinthians 3 is the story of coming out of one glory and into another. Right? Ask yourself like don't just listen to me, apply this.

How many of you need to come out of one glory and into another? How many of you have allowed senses, experience, failures, betrayals, whatever it might be, to put a new opinion of yourself on yourself that is not consistent with the glory of God? Yep. Now, do you want to hamstring every silver-tongued evangelist that you've ever heard in every tent meeting? I'm not going to do an impression. I just don't have the energy yet. I did a 70 lb kettlebell clean this morning. We've all sinned and fallen short of the glory of God, right? And they are so quick to tell you that you fell short of God's glory. And then if you ask them like, "What's that mean?" Like, "Well, I'm glad you asked."

Grabs the offering plate, walks out the back door. They don't know, right? So, if we redefine sin and glory, we realize that we have sinned, right? We have fallen short of our blueprint and we've fallen short of God's opinion of us. So, we didn't commit a crime and fall short of his expectation. We were deceived and didn't meet what he thought of us because our own self-imposed separation kept us from learning what he thinks of us. Right? This happened in Genesis. We talk talk about it often. Adam and Eve put the distance between they and their father. The father did not put the distance there. The distance that they imposed on themselves is the distance that created delusion regarding who he was and who they are.

So the very creator that came to them to take a walk with them in the cool of the day is the one that said, "We heard you coming. We were naked, so we hid." Right? And then God says, "Who told you you were naked?" Right? What's what's what's God trying to investigate? Somebody gave you a new doxa, didn't they? Somebody brought an opinion to you that you believed that is no longer consistent with what I've said about your nature. Somebody stole my image from you and erased the words very good from your conscience. What happened? Yep. This is the storyline, folks. Like this is the Genesis to Revelation story. Have you ever read the book Song of Solomon? Read it again thinking about doxa, because the first two chapters are

about a woman not thinking she's worthy of the the bridegroom's love. And then as he continues to draw her with cords of love, she starts saying better things about herself. When he refers to her, he says, "My darling, my equal." What do you think a handmaiden would have thought if a king says, "My darling, my equal"? Must have the wrong gal.

Don't have the wrong gal. Right. I don't have the wrong gal. My gal has the wrong doxa. Yep. God doesn't marry ugly chicks. Come on. He just won't. If he sets a standard for you, it's because it exists within himself. So if he tells you that you can't be unequally yoked, then neither will he be. That means his wife is the possessor of the same glory that is in the father. He will not be unequally yoked. You with me so far? Okay. So, this is what I want to do. It might take some time, so I'm going to jump into it. We're going to go through the entire book of John, excuse me, the

The case of the adulterous woman

entire chapter of John 8 because Jesus puts on a doxa clinic. And if you want to understand the mechanics of doxa, John 8 does a perfect job leaving no stone unturned. Would you like to join me there? You sure? Okay, this might not be as fun. I'm lying. It's always as fun. John chapter 8. Say amen when you're there. All right. Jesus went to the Mount of Olives. Early in the morning, he came again to the temple, and all the people came to him, and he sat down and taught them. The scribes and Pharisees brought to him a woman caught in adultery when they had set her in the midst. They said to him, "Teacher, this woman was caught in adultery in the very act."

Ready? Now Moses in the law commanded us that such a woman should be stoned. But what's your doxa? It's the whole point of the story, folks. The entire time Jesus was trying to give them the difference between the opinion of the father. He's telling them where their opinion came from. He said, 'You think Moses defines you. Moses killed you. Moses was talking about me. So when you read Moses with a veil on your heart, the same cycle of sin and death is what it produces. So put down the Moses writings, look in the face of the father, and you'll see yourself revealed from glory to glory. Jesus is about to put on a clinic with a woman being defined by Moses that in the very act of her adultery gets redefined by Jesus without him ever ever pointing fingers at her infraction.

Come on. Come on. This gospel is better than you think it is. Come on. So these people come up, they catch her. Do we have evidence? Is there a bunch of cool backstories about this? Yeah, but you can't prove any of them. Everyone's like, "Nope, she didn't do anything wrong. They just threw her at his feet." I think she did. Right. But one of the cool things about religious people is they don't say who she did it with. Why do you think that is? Yeah. Pretty

private act. Not super easy to catch somebody in. Might have been a religious trap that somebody else was involved in. Then they decide to throw the girl at his feet and the other guy's standing there like, "Get her."

Right? If that's not religion in a nutshell, I don't know what is you with me. Okay. Now Moses in the law commanded us that such a such a one should be stoned. But what do you say this? They said, testing him that they might have something of which to accuse him. But Jesus stooped down, wrote on the ground with his finger as though he did not hear. When they continued asking him, he raised himself up and said, "He who is without sin among you. Let him throw the first stone at her." And then again he stooped down to the ground. Ready? Don't read this wrong. Jesus did not say, "You're guilty. You can't stone her." Jesus simply allowed their own principle to defeat them. You want to use Moses to judge her?

Fine. But it has to judge you, too. because whatever judgment you measure with, it will be measured back to you. Right? So check this out. Right? So these these Pharisees, leaders of the law, are sitting in front of Jesus with an adulterer at his feet and says, "Moses says she's guilty. Moses says she needs punished. What do you say?" He said, "I agree. And if you're without sin, go ahead." The next line says, "And they dropped their stones and walked out, the oldest to the youngest." The longer you've been in religion, the more condemnation you carry. The longer you've been self-justifying, self-atoning, and distancing yourself from God, the faster you are to disqualify yourself, which is what we see here. So Jesus isn't disqualifying these men.

Jesus is using their own system to prove to them that the doctrine that comes through Moses leads through to separation. What would have happened if these people hadn't been under the law? He said, if listen, the Bible, the Bible itself says, where there's no law, there's no transgression. So, if Moses wasn't the foundation of their identity, then they would have been innocent. They would have killed this woman. They would have been more likely for a Gentile to start hurling boulders at this woman's head than a Jew because Jews are under a system that kills you. You with me? Right. So, this is Jesus's doxa clinic, right? He's just letting the system do the work for him. He's completely impartial. He is not trying to inject his own opinion.

He's just showing you, listen, if you live by Moses, you'll die by Moses. If you want to hurl rocks at her head, be my guest. If you're without sin, go ahead. So, he doesn't say that they're with sin. He just points out to them that separation is the result of a life lived in striving. So, they disqualify themselves from being the executioner. Now, this is what you need to understand. The other doxa was not present on earth until Jesus in flesh came. This is what John 1 says. Right? John 1 says, "No one has seen God at any time, but he has declared him. He is who has come down from the bosom of the father." So if we're talking doxa to doxa, only

one doxa existed for 4,000 years, and that was Adam's.

That which is born of flesh is flesh. So flesh begets flesh. Flesh begets flesh. Flesh begets flesh. Then God begets a son and that son is not born according to the same lineage. So now we have an alternative doxa. So these men were super comfortable stoning women before. But now that there's an alternative doxa on the planet, they can't. Now that innocence has been made available to all, then not all are condemned. The the law condemns everyone that we might be freely justified by his grace. With me so far, are we good? Okay. John 8:8. Okay. Um Oh, we could go 5, six, and seven. It's all about the same thing. Then then again he stooped down and wrote on the ground those who heard it being convicted by their conscience went out one by one beginning with the oldest even to the last and Jesus was left alone and the woman standing in the midst.

Okay so we've talked about conscience quite a bit. We are writing a book on it. We did a series on it. What you need to understand about conscience is conscience is: it's used 34 times in the New Testament by every author. It's a big deal. conscience. Conscience means shared knowledge. Suneidēsis shared knowledge. So this this the practical application of this is these guys walked out because of the knowledge they were sharing with Moses. Are you with me? Come back. You're drifting. These guys are walking out because of the knowledge that they're sharing with Moses. They were convicted by their shared knowledge. They were not partnering with the resurrected, excuse me, the incarnate Christ for truth. They were partnering with Moses. Moses is shame and guilt guilt and condemnation.

Death and condemnation. You with me so far? Okay. Don't don't leave. Don't leave. When Jesus raised himself up, he saw no one but the woman. He said to the woman, listen, he asks her two questions. Woman, where are those accusers of yours and has no one condemned you? Right? Where are those accusers and has no one condemned you? Two questions. The answer to the first one is they're gone. Answer to the second one is just mind-blowing because she says no. She just got done being thrown at the feet of Jesus with religious men pointing their finger at her. And he says, "Has no one accused you? Has no one condemned And he said, she says, "No, take a guess why. She's not a Jew." Yeah.

Yeah. Accusations don't stick when there's no law. Accusations don't stick when there's no law. So, this woman just committed a massive infraction. She's at the feet of Jesus and he says, "Are you condemned?" She's like, "Nope. Imagine this. You're in front of a church leader. You fail morally and they're like, "You feel bad?" Ah, not really. And Jesus says, "Good, stay that way. Good. Stay that way." He's not permitting the lifestyle that she was in. But he realizes that the lifestyle that she was in was probably a product of fractured identity. The only way to fix behaviors is to heal identity. The only way you can heal identity is away from a law. Yes,

that's right. You can't get right until you can get real.

Right. Chris Blackaby always says it's like as dumb as muzzling your your dog and saying he's a good boy. He's never bit anyone. You have no idea if he's a good boy until you take the muzzle off, right? That's you apart from the law. You with me so far? Okay. So, has no one condemned you? No. She says, right? And then he says, "Neither do I condemn you. Go and sin no more." All right. So, we just saw this play out. It's going to come, it's going to come through teaching in a moment, but we just saw it play out in a parable. We have a woman caught in adultery, and we have the God of the universe saying, "I'm not condemning you." Right? So, what you you actively got to see the opinion of Moses tried to define a woman.

It didn't stick. And the opinion of God define a woman and it stuck. However, you got to see the opinion of Moses define a group of Pharisees and they left the presence of God. They walked away from their creator because they were condemned by their own conscience. Have you or are you putting distance between you and the father because you don't believe what he says about you, but senses and experience are already and consistently defining who you are. So, you say, "I heard you walking towards me, so I backed up." Right? Good. All right. We're like 25% of the way there.

The witness of Jesus and the Father

She said, "No one, Lord." He said, "Neither do I condemn you. Go and sin no more." Then Jesus spoke to them again, saying, I'm the light of the world. He who follows me shall not walk in darkness, but have the light of life." Then Pharisees said, "You bear witness of yourself. Your witness isn't true." Right? You need to understand these these conversations aren't separate. These conversations aren't separate. A group of Pharisees just came together as a witness against this woman according to their law, their right. And then one man acquitted her of all charges. And they said, "You can't do that. One person's witness isn't true." Good stuff, right? Jesus answered and said, "Even if I bear witness of myself, my witness is true.

For I know where I came from and where I'm going, but you don't know where I come from or where I'm going." We could talk about that for the rest of the time. But what Jesus is saying is he's the word become flesh. He's not saying, "I know where I came from geographically." He says, "I've seen us outside of time and space. I know that I originated there. I know that I go back there. You don't know what that's like. So, you judge like your dads do." Do you know how often Jesus says, "You judge like your father. I judge like mine." Right? That's the difference between the two species. That's the difference between Adam and Christ. That's the difference between the son of man and the son of God.

You with me? So what he's saying, he said, 'If I bear witness of myself, it's true because I know who I'm one with. I know where I came from. I know where I'm going. You don't know where I came from or where I'm going, which is why you don't believe me. You believe Moses, right? So even if I bear witness of myself, my witness is true. I know where I come from and I know where I'm going. But you don't. You judge, listen, according to the flesh. Flesh means mere human perspective. It means senses and experience. So listen, do you know how difficult it is to implement a practice like this? Do you know how difficult it is to implement a practice like this, church?

Please hear me out. This woman wasn't a a a girl that got framed and thrown at their feet. This was a woman who committed an infraction against the Mosaic law and gets thrown at the feet of Jesus. And he says, "I don't care what I saw her do. I know who she is. You judge her by what she's done. I judge her according to my father's witness. So he's not saying I judge righteous people favorably. He's saying I judge no one. Literally listen. Repeat it 10,000 times. Jesus accuses these guys. He says the the the weakness of your system is that you judge according to the flesh. In the next line that Jesus says is, I judge no one. Okay. Do you think that's possible?

Do you think that's feasible? Do you think that like do you think you would be a responsible Christian if you took that posture? Probably not. But you'd be an effective one. But you would confound the wise with a system that didn't use people's behaviors to define them, but rather saw them in the father from where they came from and where they're going rather than what they're doing. Right now, please, there's a reason that this is a Doxa clinic. The reason that this is Jesus's doxa clinic is because he's showing you how to define yourself outside of your behaviors. He's not saying, "Please, oh my God, please hear me." He's not saying that you shouldn't you shouldn't define yourself by the betrayal and lies people tell about you.

He's saying you shouldn't define yourself by the truths people tell about you. much bigger gospel, right? If you want to know the difference between demonic seed and God's seed is one judges according to what they see. Usually they're not lying. Yep. What did the What did the serpent say to Eve? He's like, "No, in the day that you eat of it, you'll surely die." Surely you won't die. Listen, both of those things were true. They didn't die. They didn't die naturally. So the serpent tells a story according to senses and it's true. So you you have to quit minimizing the effects of this gospel to still kind of catering to your self-righteousness. Don't be defined by the lies and betrayal. No, don't be defined by the natural truth.

You might be an awful person. awful person. But God refuses to allow your behaviors to keep you from being redeemed. Yeah. Was this woman caught in adultery? You bet. You You bet. Yeah. You bet. Did Judas really sell Jesus for 30 shekels? You bet. Did Jesus still use Judas as

part of a redemptive story? You bet. Do you know where Judas went? Do you know that there's two kind of inconclusive records about Judas's death? One of them said he hung himself. One of them said he tried to hang himself. Do you know? You didn't know? Yeah. So, when it talks about Judas in the in the Gospels, it says that that Judas went and hung himself. When Paul talks about him, he said he tried to hang himself and the ropes broke and he burst open on the rocks.

He burst open on the rocks at the potter's field. He burst open on the rocks after taking sacraments. The blood and body in body and blood of Jesus Christ spilled out over broken vessels. So he didn't swing from a tree. He broke on the rocks and the very body and blood came out of him and washed broken vessels. So the father allowed him to be part of a gospel presentation that most people read right over. So they don't have to be lies to be untrue. You get it? You sure we're not even close to done? The Pharisees therefore said to him, "You bear witness of yourself, your witness is not true." And Jesus said, "Even if I bear witness of myself, my witness is true.

I know where I came from. I know where I'm going. You don't. You judge according to the flesh. I judge no one. But if I did, my judgment's true. I'm not alone. I am with the Father who sent me." It is also written in your law that the testimony of two men is true. I am one who bears witness of myself and the father who sent me bears witness of me. That's verse 18. So what is Jesus trying to say? Jesus is trying to give theological foundations for what just happened in the altercation with the woman caught in adultery. He's like, if you want to know why that woman stayed and your Pharisees left, it's because she listened to me. They listened to Moses.

Right? So now you who are being defined by Moses are trying to redefine me according to your law. I'll use your own law against you by saying your law says that the testimony of two men is true and I'm one with the father. So my vote counts. Yep. So if I and the father are one, then we have two votes and that makes our testimony true. So all of these Pharisees judging him according to the law of Moses are not right concerning him. And he doesn't have to allow that judgment to redefine who he is simply because they're religious leaders. You guys good so far?

Truth and bondage

Verse 19. Then they said to him, "Where's your father?" Good question, right? Jesus said, "You know neither me nor my father. If you had known me, you would also know my father. These words Jesus spoke in the treasury as he taught in the temple. And no one laid hands on him, for his hour had not yet come. Ready? Then Jesus said to them again, "I'm going away.

You will seek me and you will die in your sin. Where I go, you can't come." So the Jews said, "Will he kill himself?" Because he says, "Where you go, I can't come." And Jesus said, "Ready? Oh my God, you are from beneath. I am from above. Yep. You are of this world. I'm not of this world.

Therefore, I said to you that you will die in your sins. For if you do not believe I am he, you will die in your sins. He's giving these Pharisees the gospel. He really is. He's not threatening them. He's saying, "You've already rejected the glory of the Father and kept the glory of Moses." He's not saying, "I'll kill you in your sins." He's saying, "The glory of Moses will produce sin. And that sin produces death. So if you reject who I am, you'll stay in your state. And that ministry of death and condemnation will continue to define you. And the more you strive, the more you die. Good doxa clinic. Therefore, I said to you that you will die in your sins, for you do not believe that I am he, you will die in your sins.

Then they said to him, "Who are you?" Then Jesus said to them, "Just what I've been saying to you from the beginning. I have many things to say and judge concerning you, but he who sent me is true, and I speak to the world those things which I heard from him. So, this is a really cool verse to tie back to the moment that he was with the woman caught in adultery. Because if he says, I judge no one, that means that he may have wanted to, right? So, you can't excuse Jesus's humanity from his divinity because he's saying, "Oh, I got a lot to say about y'all." But I'm not going to because I only say what I hear the father saying. Which means the father who has previously been postured as some angry bloodthirsty deity who has only withheld his wrath because he has a hippie son means the son's actual actions towards humanity are a reflection of the father's heart and not a deflection of them.

He says I could say a lot of things about you but I'm only going to judge as my father judges. Which means I'm not going to judge you at all. Right? I'm not going to judge you at all. If I'm not going to judge you at all, your system will do all I need. You with me? Jesus said to them, "Just what I have been saying to you from the beginning. I have many things to say concern and judge concerning you, but he who sent me is true, and I speak to the world those things which I heard from him." They did not understand that he spoke to them of the father. Then Jesus said to them, "When you lift up the Son of Man, then you will know that I am he, that I do nothing of myself, but as my Father taught me, I speak these things, and he who sent me is with me.

The Father has not left me alone. I always do those things which please him." And he spoke these words. Many believed him. You ready? Are you sure you want to go through this whole Oh, it's so much longer. Then Jesus said to those Jews who believed him, "If you abide in my word, you are my disciples indeed." Right? Now what? Now what? Okay. If you read your

Bible, you're my disciples. No, somebody said if you stay in what I say, right? This this is at the end of a doxa clinic. And he's saying, you're my disciples if you listen to me and not Moses. Yep. And you shall know the truth, and the truth shall make you free. They answered and said, we have we're Abraham's descendants.

We've never been in bondage to anyone. How can you say you'll be made free? Jesus answered and said,"Most assuredly I say to you, whoever commits sin is a slave to sin," and a slave does not abide in the house forever, but a son does. Therefore, if the son makes you free, you shall be

Disputing Abrahamic lineage

free indeed. Ready? I know that you're Abraham's descendants, but you're trying to kill me because my word has no place in you. I speak what I have seen with my father, and you do (ready?) what you have seen with yours. See, this whole conversation is about the same thing. The whole conversation is about the same thing. They answered and said, 'Abraham is our father. Jesus said to them, "If you were Abraham's children, you would do the works of Abraham. But now you seek to kill me, a man who has told you the truth which I heard from God. Abraham did not do this." Oh my God. Listen. Listen. Do you want to know where Abraham messed up? Abraham's kids had no inheritance. Here's what's really cool.

They thought they did. So God obliged them, but Abraham didn't tell them the truth. Jesus isn't trying to be mystical and saying, "You read a lot of good stuff that Abraham wrote, but you didn't get it." He's saying Abraham wrote it wrong. Listen, I'm I'm not trying to be scandalous. Your Bible says, Paul says that Abraham believed that his seeds were supposed to be blessed. But the Holy Spirit indicates that he did not speak of seeds as of many, but seed, duh, as of one. Jesus Christ is the seed of Abraham. There was an entire nation for generations living under the favor of God that were never its actual recipients. So what Jesus is trying to tell these Pharisees is like, I know Abraham wrote a lot of cool things about you guys, but Abraham wasn't writing about you guys.

Abraham testified of me. So you won't find your promise in your bloodline through Abraham. You'll find your promise in your union with me because you are counted as the seed. Wow. That's so Gosh. Right. Could you imagine? Like you have Abraham's history in here and you've canonized it. You've called it infallible and you've called it inerrant and then Jesus said he's wrong. Right? How many times does Jesus come up and be like, "Yeah, Moses tried, man." Like the law came through Moses. I'll give you truth. He says the same thing about Abraham right now. He's like, "If you abide in my word, you're my disciples. If you stay in my word, my truth will set you free." Abraham said he could do it. He can't.

You with me? I know you're Abraham's descendants, but you seek to kill me because my word has no place in you. I speak what I have seen with my father and you do what you have seen with yours. That's the problem, right? Then Abraham said, uh, excuse me. Then they answered and said to him, Abraham's our father. And he said, if you were Abraham's children, you would do the works of Abraham. But now you seek to kill me, a man who has told you the truth which I heard from God. Abraham did not do this. Abraham did not tell you the truth that he heard from God. You do the deeds of your father. Listen. Do you know what the works of Abraham are?

Do you know what the works of Abraham are? It's recognizing a man with no past, no future, no father or mother and honoring him for who he is. His name was Melchizedek in the Old Testament. Yeah. Jesus, a Christophany, shows up in front of Abraham and Abraham says, "That's the guy that I need to honor." The works of Abraham are to believe in whom he sent. Yeah. Yeah. So much that there's a promise concerning his son. How many of you when you want to be like Abraham, you're like, "Fine, I'll let God kill something I love." Yeah. That's not the work of Abraham. The work of Abraham is knowing that nothing you love can be killed. The reason Abraham shoved his son on an altar is because there was a promise concerning his son and he said, "Listen, I'm going to throw him up there.

I have the knife in my hand and either God is going to raise my kid from the dead or he's going to give me provision so he doesn't die because the promises of God are yes and amen. Abraham wasn't justified by his obedience like these guys were trying to be. Abraham was justified by his belief in a good father who is a proponent of life everlasting. Amen. So when he says this, he's like Abraham didn't tell you the truth. tried, tried, so tried, but he did not have divine perspective. Right? It's not that he didn't tell you the truth because he's a liar. It's because he didn't tell you the truth because he had not seen the glory of God. Good so far. Then they said to him, "We were not born of fornication.

We have one father, God." Jesus said to them, "If God were your father, you would love me. For I proceeded forth and came from God. Nor have I come of myself, but he sent me. Why do you not understand my speech? Because you're not able to listen to my word. You are of your father, the devil. And the desires of your father you want to do. He was a murderer from the beginning and does not stand in the truth because there's no truth in him. When he speaks a lie, he speaks of his own resources. For he is a liar and the father of it. But because I tell you the truth, you don't believe me. Which of you convicts me of sin? And if I tell the truth, why do you not believe me?

He who is of God hears God's words. Therefore, you do not hear because you're not of God. You good so far? Okay. So, how about this? This is really intense. I'd like to simplify it for us

because I think we're less married to the legalist the legalistic system that these guys were married to. But what he's saying is as long as you're trying to strive, you can't hear the father, right? The moment that you reach to become something that you already are, the father's voice is drowned out. The father's voice only echoes through rest. They answered and said, 'We are Abraham's descendants. We've never been in bondage to anyone. How can you say you'll be made free? Jesus answered and said,"Most assuredly I say to you, whoever commits sin is a slave to sin."

We're way past that, aren't we? Verse 48. Then the Jews answered and said to him, "Do we not say rightly that you are a Samaritan and have a demon?" Jesus answered and said, "I do not have a demon, but I honor my father and you dishonor me. I do not seek ready." This is the whole point. I do not seek my own glory. There is one who seeks and judges. Most assuredly I say to you, if anyone keeps my word, he shall never see death. It's just there, homie. Like, it's just there. But what's the point? Okay, this is, like I said, this is a lot. It's a lot. And I highly recommend that you go take a scalpel to this this chapter for like the next month because it's all the same story.

He's showing them the impairment in their system. The impairment in their system is that the harder they strive, the the shorter they fall. Their longest standing um legalistic leader was the first one to walk out at the invitation. And the story is always the same. They're like, "Well, Abraham's our dad." He's like, "Doesn't matter." He said, "We're of God." No, you're not right. You want to kill me, which means you're not like your dad. And I don't I don't want to revisit this a thousand times over. He's not saying Moses's writings were about Jesus. What he's saying is that, excuse me, Abraham's writings were about Jesus. What he's saying is Abraham's writings missed it because everything that was was said concerning Abraham, they believed were about his natural lineage.

Let me give you some insight into this because even the prophets set it up for us. First, it says that Abraham's descendants are as numerous as the sand on the seashore, right? That's dirt and that's limited. And then when we get the prophetic unction that actually helps us understand the fulfillment of the Abrahamic promise, which was not to seeds, but to seed as of one, not seeds as of many. It says that his descendants will be as numerous as the stars in the expansive and ever-increasing supernatural sky. That's not a lineage. That's not his paternal order of descendants. That is everyone universally gathered in the one man, Christ, the Lord of heaven. Right after it says that he's not talking about seeds, he's talking about seed.

He says, "And you're counted as the seed." Abraham has one kid. God has one kid. You with me? You're Abraham's descendants. You're Abraham's descendant. Both are true. Oh man. You ready? Okay. I don't have a demon, right? I hate having to say that to people. Most

assuredly I say to you, whoever keeps my word shall never see death. Then the Jews said to him, "Now we know that you have a demon. Abraham's dead." And the prophets and you say, "If anyone keeps my word, he shall never taste death." Listen, they think Abraham kept his word. Now, we know you have a demon. You said, "If you keep God's word, you don't die." He's trying to tell them Abraham didn't. Jesus answered and said, "If I honor, listen to this, please.

If I honor myself, my honor is nothing. It is my father who honors me. Of whom you say that he is your God, yet you have not known him, but I know him. And if I say I do not know him, I am a liar like you. But I do know him and keep his word. So, do you know what he's saying? I'm telling the truth by saying I know him. You're lying by saying you know him. But again he comes back to this honor thing right? Dokeō, doxa, and other derivatives of that Greek word. He's saying if I form an opinion of myself it means nothing my father formed this opinion of me of whom you say he's your god so if he's your god and that's his opinion of me then you'd believe me when I say that I'm his son so either I'm wrong or you're wrong.

I've seen him. You haven't. You have not known him, but I know him. And if I say I don't know him, I'm a liar like you. But I do know him and keep his word. Your father Abraham, he rejoiced to see my day and saw it and was glad. Then the Jews said to him, "You're not even 50 years old." And you say, "You saw Abraham." Then Jesus said,"Most assuredly I say to you, before Abraham was, I am." Right? This is back to the first 10 verses. I know where I came from. I know where I'm going. The reason that I am completely confident in the word spoken over me is because I am the word spoken over me. Amen. Come on. My witness is true.

You don't believe me? Because you judge like your dad judges. Well, who's your dad? Abraham. Wrong. Guess again. Your father's the devil. Yeah. Wait a minute. Why? No. No. No. No. It's not as intense as you think. The devil's the one that told you you had to do something to become something. So now that you're in this system of striving and trying, you've entered in to the ministry of death and condemnation. So you listen, just like your dad, anytime you speak, you're speaking of your own resources. So the system that is keeping you out, you're trying to use to keep me out, but you can't because the one that you call God said, "I'm in." Yep. It's good stuff, right? Oh, we're almost to the end, right?

If I honor myself, if I define myself, my definition is nothing. It's my father that defined me, of whom you say is your God. You have not known him, but I do know him. I'm going to not read that again. That'll be the third time. Then Jesus said, most assuredly, I say to you, before I am, excuse me, before Abraham was, I am. Then they took up stones to throw at him. But Jesus hid

Healing the blind man

himself and went out of the temple going through the midst of them as he passed by. Now check this out. Ready? Oh man, I wasn't going to go here. We're going to go through all of chapter 9. I'm lying to you. We're going to start at the very beginning. But check this out. Now, as Jesus passed by, he saw a man that was blind. And his disciples asked him, "Rabbi, who sinned? This man or his parents that he was born blind?" Jesus said, "Neither this man nor his parents sinned. Too excited. In for four, hold for four. Out for four. Start over. Ready? Now, as Jesus passed by, he saw a man who was blind from birth. His disciples asked, saying, "Rabbi, who sinned?

This man or his parents?" That he was born blind. Then Jesus said, "Neither this man nor his parents sinned, but the works of God should be revealed in him. I must work, excuse me, I must work the works of him who sent me while it's day. The night's coming when no one can work. As long as I'm in the world, I'm the light of the world, right? Good stuff so far. Okay, so that's Jesus's doxa clinic. I don't know if I can really wrap that up other than you've got 50 verses of homework to do. Right. But he systematically shows you what it looks like to have a woman caught in adultery thrown at your feet and live according to a system that's outside time and space.

Then he shows you what it looks like to be the woman standing before the Pharisees and be able to function in a realm where you're trying to be defined by senses and experience and still stand against it because the God of the universe has an opinion of you that trumps all other opinions. Your Bible says, "Let God be true and every man be a liar." Right? So, he doesn't just show you how to judge the woman. He shows you how to be the woman. Right? And then he shows you how to stand for yourself. Listen, imagine going through this. You're a bad messiah. You let this woman go. You're a bad messiah. What you say is a lie. You're a bad messiah. God's not your dad.

Well, fine. I'm leaving. Where are you going? To heal a blind man because the opinions of religious people don't move me. Yes. If we went through what Jesus went through in John 8 in our entire lives, we'd have quit ministry by now. Good.

Closing ministry and prayer

All right. Stand with me. Would you Is your guitar out? Do you mind? Okay. Ricky, can I bother bother you? Borrow you? Um, Jen Porter, Kaylee, please you guys come up. Becca, please join me. All right, listen. Um, you know, the the local church is an absolutely beautiful thing, right? Like the most glorious thing on the planet is a gathering of saints. And it's it's multifunctional. It's a place of corporate worship. It's a place of apostolic doctrines and teachings. It's a place to pray for one another, but it's not a place of performance. So, one of the

things that I've always contended with is like it seems like in some churches like after the messages, the show, you know, like here's we do the fun stuff, right?

And I agree. I love miracles. I love signs, wonders. I love deliverance. I love the whole deal. But I don't want to lose like the I don't want to lose the thing where somebody's just like I had a bad week. Yeah. I just need somebody. If you can make me feel 1% better, I'll survive. Like, you know, I'm I'm I want the miracles. But like this this this is a family. So if if what I what I spoke this morning like yes, I am absolutely being defined by doctrines of devils. I am absolutely allowing the opinions of religious people to take a toll on my nervous system. I am absolutely further away than I've ever been from the opinion of God on my life.

Part 3

The Power of Perspective

Okay, you ready? Ready. All right, this is this is a rough one. So good. But I want to tell you a really silly story and you're not going to have any idea how it's revalent. Relevant. You don't know what just happened to me. I just committed one of my own cardinal sins. One of my own cardinal sins. I was at a conference once and they had invited a guest speaker to come take the offering and uh he said revalent and everybody giggled like that. So without realizing that he had switched some letters the giggle became the kerosene on his revalent fire. So he said revalent about 19 more times and I can't hear or say revalent ever again. I almost left the ministry because of the word revalent which isn't a word but it just made my soul hurt, you know.

So relevant. I'm going to tell you a story. You understand why it's relevant soon. I and a number of my friends got to be in a question and response time with David Crowder. Do you guys know who that guy is? Okay. Arguably one of the best musicians that our generation has seen in the Christian music world or maybe others. Like he is just brilliant genius. Okay. Somebody asked him the question, "What's the songwriting process like for you?" And this was his answer. He said, "Have you ever been doing the dishes and a bubble floats up and you know if you look at it, it's going to pop?" He said, "That's the songwriting process for me." You know, when God drops something in you, if you put human hands on it, you'll mess it up.

So, I'm sitting in my office this week studying and studying and studying and studying and studying. It's fruitless and fruitless and fruitless and then something dropped. I'm like and then I went like this. Okay, just don't look at it. If you look at it, it'll pop. So, whatever that was, I'm going to try to let it out now. Okay. It's extremely important in understanding the entire biblical narrative, but it's even more important in understanding what God wants to do with you and why he'd like to do it. Okay,

Defining glorification

we've talked through the Greek word doxa for three weeks now. I'm going to introduce you to another iteration of that same term. This is the Greek word doxazō. Doxa means glory, right? Or it's translated to glory. The definition is the thoughts, opinions or estimate of a thing. It's how something is thought of. It's its reputation, right? Doxazō is that opinion being visibly substantiated before witnesses. We translate doxa to glory, doxazō into glorify. Okay, we're about to enter into one of those places in theology where you didn't realize you had no clue what the Bible was talking about. Right? So all through the New Testament there is a concept

of glorification. And if I asked you what glorification meant, there is a solid chance that you would have no clue how to define it.

Ask me how I know 'cause I learned yesterday. And the church has not done us any favors regarding our Christian words because we use them so frequently that we never take the time to add substance to their meaning. To glorify something is to take the doxa the opinion and validate and verify it in front of witnesses. So if something has a glory right like you and I do then glorification is proving that that glory is substantially true. Okay. Now, I'm going to walk you through some chronology in the Bible so you understand why things went the way they went. You see how slow I'm going? That's not for you. That's for me. Yep.

The problem of distance

So, a god that humanity has distanced themselves from cannot glorify him because their opinion of him is wrong. Adam could have glorified God before they fell. You with me? He couldn't after he heard God coming in the garden and said, "I heard you coming. I was naked, so I hid." His view of God now is tarnished. So the opinion that God would have had, excuse me, that Adam would have had of God would have been error. And it was error so much that 4,000 years of human lineage separated themselves from a god that was pursuing them and everything they thought of him was brought to them by their own self-imposed separation. So a humanity that has distanced themselves from God cannot glorify him because their doxa of him is not accurate.

And now you have a massive conundrum because you have an invisible God that no longer has an advocate on earth that can accurately represent him to humanity. God listen can't glorify himself. Yeah. Wait, it gets better. Here's how you know: all of these things in the New Testament talking about the glory and honor of God, they're not spiritual things. They're talking about a judicial system by which verdicts are passed. When the Pharisees come to judge Jesus, they said, "Your witness isn't true." Why? because you only have one voice that affirms it. So what's Jesus saying? He said, "I don't. My father glorifies me." Right? My father honors me and I honor me. So that's according to your law. The voice of two witnesses makes it true.

But one of the things this is this is so good for you to understand like how to walk theology back. Jesus said, 'If I honor myself, this is Jesus Christ, this is God, okay? If I honor myself, my honor is nothing. Jesus Christ said, "If I honor myself, my honor is nothing." Okay? So, you can't honor yourself. best news you've ever heard. Right? No matter what you say that is inconsistent about what he says only has one vote. Therefore, your witness isn't true. Okay. Here's the system though. One voice isn't true. You have God invisible spirit who is now being

distanced from humanity through their own self-imposed distance. That spirit cannot glorify himself to humanity. The rule now is a human voice has to substantiate his glory to humanity or it doesn't count. Right. You want me to make this make sense now? You okay? Yes. Yes. Okay. So, Adam and Eve self-imposed distance. They thought the God that was pursuing them was coming to punish them.

Moses and the system

They have the wrong opinion of God. Therefore, what they say about him isn't true. It's not glorification. It's not substantiated according to the second witness, which is him. So, we move on to Abraham. Abraham meets a pre-incarnate Christ in Melchizedek, right? No beginning nor end of days, without father, without mother. He meets Melchizedek, the priest. But we learned last week, and I don't want to get into this, that Abraham had a natural mind according to fallen lineage and misrepresented the promise of God concerning his lineage. Abraham thought that promise was for his sons and daughters. So now Abraham's descendants become the people of God. And Romans Paul writes that God was not talking to Abraham about his seeds as of many. He was talking to him about his seed as of one, which is Christ.

So, we have an entire lineage of Abrahamic descendants that ultimately end up in captivity in Egypt. The only way they know who their God is is their God is the God of Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob. Right? Abraham, the grandfather, started out with the wrong narrative. It got passed down through generations till we get to this group of people that are in bondage for 400 years. So that means Adam generations upon generations gets to Abraham. Abraham gets to Isaac. Isaac gets to Jacob. Jacob produces this continued lineage. All of them all of them are wrong about who God is because their definition of him is sewn in distance and delay. You ready? It's about to get wild. So somehow we have to bring a redeemer to these people that's just like them but not a part of them.

Get it? Somehow this little baby Moses who is an Israelite gets sent up river and adopted by Pharaoh's daughter so he doesn't grow up in a system of error. He doesn't grow up as in a system of error, but rather he grows up as royalty. You with me? So Abraham accidentally kills, not accidentally, very purposely kills an Egyptian, gets banished to the backside of a mountain, and sees a burning bush that starts talking to him. The miracle isn't that Moses continued to talk to a burning bush. The miracle is that Moses didn't feel disqualified to continue to talk to a burning bush. That's so good. That's so because if the burning bush would have showed up to an Israelite, they would have fallen on their face and said, "We're a sinful nation and you've fallen upon unclean lips."

Right? So Abraham was qualified to be a deliverer because he grew up outside the system. Exodus 11 says that Moses, did I say Abraham was qualified? Sorry, Ethan, call me out on these things. Moses was qualified to be a deliverer because he was one of them, but he grew up outside of them. So he wasn't being judged by the system that kept them in bondage. So God needs to find the guy that he can according to Exodus 11 speak to face to face as a man talks to his friend which had not happened in thousands of years because of distance and delay. You with me?

The wilderness pattern

So now beautiful now you can now you really really can understand the ebbs and flows of this biblical narrative. So Moses meets God, hears a voice coming from the burning bush, and his immediate response isn't, "God's here. I got to run because that's what thousands of years of my ancestors have done." His response is to argue with him for a little while, right? And then he takes on a task. And then Hebrews says, "Moses refused to be called the son of Pharaoh's daughter, yet rather chose to suffer the bondage of the Israelites." So he comes from outside the system into the system as one of them, but apart from them so that he can redeem them. Sound familiar? Yeah. Yeah. Sounds super familiar. But why is Moses the guy?

Because Moses can glorify God. Moses doesn't have a veil over his face yet. Yeah. We see Moses get ruined. We see Moses get ruined. And I I want I want to show you this. Right. So So the second they depart from Egypt, they come out into the wilderness and they're hungry. So God, excuse me, Moses petitions God. He's like, "Hey, these these people are complaining a lot. It'd be super helpful if you could just feed them." Yeah. Manna starts raining from heaven. Why do you think manna started raining from heaven? Because a man asked. A man not ruined by distance and delay asked. They move on and they get thirsty. They come upon some water and the water's bitter. So they see a Facebook ad for prepper straws, which are pretty popular right now, right?

I bought like 10. I really did. Yeah, really did. Water's important, right? Anyway, so he asked God, he's like, "Hey, complaining again. Help me out." So what's he do? Take that stick, toss it in the water. Problem solved. Why'd this happen? 'Cause a man outside the system asked, right? This is the pattern that we continue to see in the wilderness until we get to Mount Sinai. What happens at Mount Sinai? The law. Right? So the man that was outside the system that came into the system to deliver them gets sucked into the system. Everything from the mountain through to the promised land is now full of punishment, distance, and delay. He asks the same questions. Hey God, we're hungry. He gets nothing. Why do you think he gets nothing?

Not because God's mad at him. He won't ask. You with me? Only a human can substantiate the accurate reputation of God. Only a human can accurately substantiate the reputation of God. Only humans destroyed the reputation of God. So only a human can accurately substantiate, glorify, God. Are you with me so far? Okay. So from Mount Sinai on humanity is done. No more favor, right? No more blessings. It's just curse upon curse upon curse upon curse, right? And then we have royalty that chooses to leave the throne and come suffer with his people. Yeah. Sound familiar? Yeah. But this guy somehow I don't think is going to get sucked into the system. Right. So listen, this is this isn't even the important stuff. This is just the stuff that you need to understand before we move forward. Okay?

Jesus as the authorized voice

Glorification isn't Jesus's ascension over death. Glorification isn't the moment that he started glowing on the mountain. Glorification was the moment that God said, "That's my kid. In him I am well pleased." Do you know that the audible voice of God was not heard in scripture from the Ten Commandments to the moment that Jesus was baptized in the Jordan? I'm not saying he wasn't speaking, but what I am saying is that there was a lot of ears shut because of distance and delay. You with me? So the glorification, listen, ready? The glorification of Jesus Christ qualifies Jesus Christ to glorify his father in order. How many of you want God to get glory? Okay, good. You're the only one that can do it. You're it. Right.

John 15. By this my father's reputation is substantiated that you bear much fruit. By this my father is glorified that you bear much fruit. So playing small and falsely humble as a Christian not the game not the intention that God had for you from apart from the foundation of the world. God's reputation is made made known to creation through you no longer playing small and self-righteous. Oh yes. Right. The title, you know what the title of my message? Title of my message is intentionally provocative so that you you have a new way to pray. The title of my message today is glorify me. 10 years I started praying that 10 years I started praying that 10 years ago. Glorify me. Do you know the next line? that I may glorify you.

Right? Listen, there's an order to this. God cannot be glorified until you are. Only a human opinion can substantiate the truth of God. He is an invisible spirit that humanity has distanced themselves from. If they're going to see him, they have to see him in you. These are judicial patterns. When Thomas asked Jesus to show him the father, he said, "I am." Jesus's incarnation was the glorification of the father. However, Jesus could not be glorified if he was a descendant of Adam. So, we have to find a guy that wasn't born into the system, that didn't have Adam as a biological heir. but rather chooses to not be called the son of Pharaoh's daughter or not stay on the throne in heaven but rather puts on a body enters into your delusion crushes it from the inside out.

So here's what happens. Jews are looking for a messiah for years. They have something called the Old Testament. That Old Testament is referred to as a canon. Okay, we've ruined that word, too, right? Canon just means it's official. That's not what canon means. Canon means measuring stick. So, the reason they had a canon is because they're looking at these Old Testament prophetic words and they're waiting on a guy to come fulfill them all. They're waiting on a guy to come fulfill them all. The chances of him fulfilling them all are, you should look it up. I think it was Moody that did the actual math. One person fulfilling 10 of them is the equivalent of covering the state of Texas with silver dollars a foot deep, grabbing one, marking it with an X, mixing up the whole state, and then going and grabbing a second one, and the second one being that one. 10 of them.

There's like 280 messianic prophecies that he fulfilled meticulously with extreme precision throughout his entire life. Right? You with me so far? So, oh shoot. You okay? There were moments in Jesus's ministry where he refused to minister for a reason. Does anyone remember the reason? Son of man has not yet been glorified. Yeah. So his ministry hadn't begun because his ministry wouldn't be accepted because the father hadn't substantiated his approval on the son yet. You with me? But the father has to visibly substantiate the reputation of Jesus in order for Jesus's word to be established as truth. So, the father can't be glorified until the reputation of the son is established. Get it? I'm going to I'm going to get scripture. A lot of it actually.

Completing the mission

So, just like Moses, God sends himself incarnate. And it doesn't matter what God says of himself. Humanity is distant from him. So, they don't get it. However, they have become a sensual people and they have heaped up for them human teachers. So, God is going to have to reveal himself to the sensual human through the voice that they'll receive, which is a substantiated human. So Jesus fulfills all of these moments where he becomes prophetically significant and all of the messianic prophecies are fulfilled. And then there's a moment where Judas betrays him and he says, "Now, now the son of man has been glorified." It wasn't his death. It wasn't his crown. It wasn't his beating. It wasn't his entombment. It wasn't his resurrection. It wasn't his enthronement.

It was the completion of the messianic prophecies, especially concerning the one of his betrayal. The voice of the father from heaven was not heard from the giving of the ten commandments to the baptism in the Jordan. But God speaks from heaven, glorifies his son. Now his son becomes a reliable source of truth concerning the father. Do you get it? Now, all this language, I know that I'm really heaping this on. Like, seems like the more I talk, the muddier it gets. But I I know that we're going to great lengths to understand this. I'll give you the application in a moment. Jesus now being glorified by the father becomes an authorized

voice to represent the father to you. So all of the language concerning the father in in Jesus's incarnation is this.

No one has seen God at any time. Really important for you to know, right? When Jesus confronts the Jews, he's like, Moses wrote the law. I'm bringing you grace and truth. Right? He tells Abraham's descendants, I am telling you the truth. Abraham did not do this. So he's disqualifying every human opinion that has ever been distributed through an unauthorized witness. And he becomes the authorized witness because he's the one that's been glorified, substantiated, authorized, verdict passed by the father. So now every time somebody is questioning him or teaching him or or Paul is talking about him, he's like the son of God, he has declared him and he can declare him because he's glorified. Are you with me? Okay, good stuff so far, right? So in order for God to be accurately glorified, you have to be accurately glorified first, right?

We love him because he first loved us. Right? By this my father's reputation is established that you bear much fruit. Thomas comes to Jesus and says, "Show us the father and it'll be sufficient for us." He said, "If you've seen me, you've seen him." Jesus is the glorification of the father, right? The son of man, he has declared him. The way Paul wrote it, he said that Jesus Christ is the express image of the father. So that means Jesus now is the final verdict concerning who the father is. The father can't reveal himself to fallen distant humanity outside of a human body. He glorifies the human body. The human body then glorifies him back. See what would happen if I studied that before I did this.

Shand would come in to wake me up this morning. Okay, now you ready? I'm going to give you the the uh like like from the Greek text. Okay. Glorify is the visible manifestation of the father's verdict concerning something. Doxa, ready for this? Means to magnify and render an opinion. To cause the dignity and worth of something to become manifest and acknowledged. I'm sorry, that's doxazō. I'm going to read it to you again. to magnify and render an opinion to cause the dignity and worth of something to become manifest and acknowledged. That's right out of the Strong's. So glorify doesn't mean that you make it glow. Glorify doesn't mean that you make it glitter. Glorify doesn't mean that you make it smoke. Glorify means that what the father says about it is now visible to onlookers.

Good. Glory is the opinion. Glorification is the visible proof of that opinion to creation. Jesus became the father's point of glorification, the magnifying glass that shut out all other perceptions and paint that painted God as separate, angry, vengeful, and tyrannical. Jesus became the laser-focused portrait of the heavenly father in an Old Testament full of floodlights that never quite got it right.

Lazarus and the glory of God

You ready? Are you sure? We're going to spend some time in John. Is that all right? Let's go to John 11. Oh, what time is it? Oh my gosh, that was my intro. You guys good? Is it good so far? Oh boy. Okay, go to John. Yeah, we'll go to John 11. It's going to take a minute. You might need a stretch. We'll start in verse one. Yeah, we don't have to go very far in this. Ready? Now a certain man was sick, Lazarus of Bethany, the town of Mary and her sister Martha. It was Mary that anointed the Lord with fragrant oil and wiped his feet with her hair, whose brother Lazarus was sick. Therefore the sister sent to him saying,"Lord, behold, the one whom you love is sick."

When Jesus heard that, he said to his disciples, "Ready? The sickness is not unto death, but for the glory of God." Meaning death is not the opinion of God. The doxa of God competes, destroys death. Ready? That the son of God may be glorified through it. Right? How many times have you read that and never thought one time to stop and say, "What on earth does that mean?" Right? And then what happens? This is why you can answer those questions more favorably. Now Jesus gets to the tomb and he starts praying out loud. Why does he start praying out loud? To be glorified. He wants them to see what it looks like for a son to petition their father and the father to respond to a son.

He literally says, normally I wouldn't have to say anything, but for the people onlooking, glorify me. Right? Glorify me. Jesus's glorification isn't for the sake of him being established as the son. Jesus's glorification is for the sake of establishing him as a credible second witness. If the father glorifies the son, then the son can glorify the father. Then that which was lost can be restored. Okay, this is huge. Huge. Okay, how many of you know that Jesus came to seek and save that which was lost? Okay, how many of you know there are multiple upgrades to that revelation? Right? Because if you're like a well-meaning 30-fold evangelical, lost people are sinners, right? So Jesus came to seek and save those who are lost. He didn't say that, right?

So then you upgrade and now you're Pentecostals and uh now we want the spirit back, right? We don't want people back. No. No. Especially if they don't agree with us. Now we want the spirit back, right? So Jesus comes to redistribute the spirit of God. Another upgrade, right? Then we become grace camp people. Jesus came to reestablish the identity of humanity. That's what was lost. No. Right. All of those are fruits of one thing that was sacrificed on the altar of self-righteousness, which was the image of the father. Okay. If you restore the image of the father, the rest of creation falls into divinity as a cascade effect. Yes. Yes. Okay. How many of you have read that part where Jesus is praying and he says, "Father, I'm going to skip this part in John 17.

He said, "I have finished the work. I have finished the work." And because we didn't understand what glorification was, we thought these were two separate statements. Jesus says, "Father, I have glorified your name." Period. I have finished the work that you gave me to do. The incarnation of Jesus accomplished one thing. In turn, that one thing accomplished everything. Yep. So the thing that Jesus came to do was to reestablish the nature of the father from an authorized voice. I have

Restoring the father's image

glorified your name. I have established your reputation with a second witness on earth. I finished what you sent me to do. Now, now what happens? The father glorifies the son. Why? So the son can glorify the father. Why? So the father can glorify you because you wouldn't have listened to him before. It's a little bubble. Don't look at it. Don't look at it or you'll pop it. You with me? Glory is the opinion. Glorification is the visible proof of that opinion to creation. God could no longer define humanity because his reputation had been ruptured through distance. So God needs to glorify a human. He can't glorify you. You won't listen. He glorifies one that isn't tainted by Adamic delusion. And then that one glorifies him.

Now his voice is reestablished in creation as an authority. So now when he says you're blameless, sinless, spotless, and holy, and you say you're blameless, sinless, spotless, and holy, you're now agreeing with a substantiated witness who has the authorization to define you. Amen. Good stuff, right? Oh my gosh. Okay, how about this? We used to sing a song. It was uh magnify the Lord, right? You ever think of that? Like what's that mean? Make it bigger. Just means to focus on it, see it clearly. So one of the definitions of doxazō is to magnify. So you become this point of laser focus. It's like if somebody has a question about the nature of the father, just like look at Ricky. Why do we get to look at Ricky and determine who the father is?

Because the father determined who Ricky is. I can't handle this. Adam distanced humanity from the father. The son brought the excuse me, the son brought the glory of God. The father had to glorify the son so the son could glorify the father. Now the father is a reauthorized voice in creation to glorify you. If you've never understood the terms testimony and witness now you do. Right? When when we semantically saturate these overly Christianized words, we lose we lose so much. The the the point of the biblical narrative is that Adam caused humanity to fall short of the glory of God. Right? So now God's opinion is no longer the dictating narrative of humanity. It needs reestablished. It can't be reestablished outside of an authorized human voice.

Can't can't glorify a human unless he's untainted by Adamic delusion. So we have him born of a virgin, right? No Adamic dad. God is his dad. So now we have a human witness. The human witness tells us, shows us, reveals to us who the father is. Now the father has regained authorization in humanity to redefine you. And now creation is looking for what? manifest sons, glorified sons. Humanity that has been stamped, sealed, delivered with the doxa of the father so that it might be fulfilled, the whole earth will be filled with his glory. Holy smokes, y'all. Good. John 15. I've been told I do this eyebrow thing. I didn't know it, but now that I know it, kind of makes me want to do the people's elbow, too, you know? Yeah, The Rock. He did the people's eyebrow and then he pulled off that elbow pad. Bounce ring to ring. Boom. It's going to be a new thing, right? We'll call it the Son's elbow.

The vine and the branches

John 15. You ready? How much of this do you want to go through? I'm the vine. My father's the vine dresser. Every branch of me that doesn't bear fruit, he takes away. And every branch that bears fruit, he prunes that it might bear more fruit. You're already clean because of the word that I spoke to you. Abide in me and I in you. As the branch can't bear fruit of itself unless it abides in the vine, neither can you unless you abide in me. I'm the vine, you are the branches. He who abides in me and I in him bears much fruit. For without me you can do nothing. Good, right? If anyone does not abide in me, he is cast out as a branch and withered, and they gather them, throw them into the fire, and they're burned.

Ready? If you abide in me and my words abide in you, you will ask what you desire, and it will be done for you. Let's stop there and talk about Moses, right? Moses asked until Mount Sinai and then Moses's questions didn't get good responses, right? Because the law cursed Moses with the rest of the nation. When Moses brought the book of the law into the tabernacle, he set it alongside the ark of the covenant as a witness against Israel. Like that was his whole purpose was to condemn an entire nation with Moses included. You with me so far? We're going to end in verse eight. Then we're going to go to finish in John 17. By this my father is glorified that you bear much fruit so you will be my disciples.

Right? By this my father is glorified. There's an Old Testament prophecy that people use to make you feel bad about yourself all the time. Religious people love it. Self-righteous people love it. It says that God will not share his glory with another. Yep. You ain't another, homie. Yeah. Yeah. You're not another, right? You don't have a glory separate from the one that you're in union with. In order for you to be the glory of God, you do not have to be distinct. You're included. Good. How could you ever ever want separation over this? John 17. This is where we'll end. I don't Oh, okay. 1 through 10. Does that work? Jesus spoke these words, lifted up his eyes to heaven, and said, "Father, the hour has come.

Glorify your son." Right? This is where our title comes from. glorify your son. Why? That your son also may glorify you. Yep. Good. So, have you stopped I know it's only been like 45 minutes, but have you stopped thinking like religious things when I say glorify yet? Good. It takes a while. When I say glorify, there's lights and smoke and fog and like zero like solid definitions of what this means. What Jesus is asking though right here, glorify your son. What's that mean? Establish my reputation. And as someone in creation with your established reputation, let me show creation who you are. Come on. Yeah. Manifest sonship. The entire world is looking for you to be glorified. Yes. as you have given him authority over all flesh that he should give eternal life to as many as you have given him.

Stop there. You have given him authority over all flesh that you might have authority over everyone you gave him, which is all flesh, right? Yeah. It doesn't say you gave him authority over all flesh that he might give eternal life to the ones that he chooses. Man, ready for this? And this is eternal life that you may that that they may know you, the only true God and Jesus Christ whom you have sent. Okay, let's talk about that real quick. I used to not like when preachers said this because it made me feel funny, but it doesn't make me feel funny anymore. Do you know Adam knew Eve? and they begot a son that you might know God and Jesus Christ whom he sent. This isn't some superficial acknowledgement.

This is the recognition of indistinguishable union as in a marriage. Yes. So that the two can bear fruit together. We're on the heels of John 15, right? I'm the vine, you're the branches. Apart from me, you can bear no fruit. Listen, he's not This isn't like a superiority statement. This is like a husband saying to a wife, apart from me, you can't really have any kids. Yep. It's not it's it's not being machismo. It's just true. You know, this is how word works. Ready? Verse four. I have glorified you on earth. I have finished the work which you gave me to do. So now you don't have to be boggled by that answer. What did Jesus come to do? To establish the father's reputation on earth. And now father glorify me together with yourself. Ready? with the glory which I

Unity in the father's glory

had with you before the world was good stuff. So what's what's what's the father trying to to establish in us? Not a new reputation. The reputation that you had have apart from time and space. Yeah. Yeah. So Jesus says, I did what you told me to do. Now you do what you said you'd do, which is give me the glory that you and I have together apart from this 33 and 1/2 year existence that I just bumped into to come save humankind. Listen, because the glory that he now has that is apart from time and space, he's about to give away. Yes. Now, Father, glorify me together with yourself with the glory that I had with you before the world was. I have manifested your name to the men who you have given me out of the world.

They were yours. You gave them to me and I they have kept your word. Now they have known that all things which you have given me are from you. For I have given to them the words which you have given me. And they have received them and have known surely that I came forth from you. And they have believed that you sent me. Ready? I pray for them. I do not pray for the world, but for those whom you have given me. For they are yours and all mine are yours and yours are mine and I am glorified in them. We're tracing this thing down. It's like nesting dolls. Now, I was only going to go to 10. I don't think we're permitted to only go to 10.

Now, I am no longer in the world, but these are in the world, and I come to you, Holy Father. Keep them through your name. Those whom you have given me that they may be one as we are one. While I was with them in the world, I kept them in your name. Those whom you gave me, I have kept and none of them is lost except the son of perdition. That the scripture might be fulfilled. Should we talk about that? Okay. Have you ever read Luke 15? Luke 15 is about prodigal son, right? Might be about Judas because the same term used to talk about this poor dumb kid that ran away and started prodigal living is the same term that we translate into the son of perdition, which sounds like it should be on like a Halloween album.

Like it's like the title on a heavy metal CD cover. It just means the lost son. What does the father do with lost sons? He redeems him. He redeems him. Yeah. Judas didn't have quite the faith that you may think he did. Ready? But now I come to you and these things I speak in the world that they may have joy fulfilled in themselves. I gave them your word. The world has hated them because they're not of this world just as I'm not of this world. I don't pray that you should take them out of the world, but that you should keep them in the world, but keep them from the evil one. They are not of the world just as I'm not of the world.

Sanctify them by your truth. As you sent me into the world, I also have sent them. For their sakes, I sanctify myself that they may also be sanctified by truth. Ready? We're going to go to verse 20 through verse 20. And I'll stop when we're done. Just so you all know, I do not pray for these alone, but also for those who will believe in me through their word. That's you. That they may all be one as you, Father, are in me and I am in you. That they also might be one in us. That the world may believe that you sent me. Here's another one of those things that you can't just glance over because he doesn't say hope they're one like they can put their arms around each other and sing kumbaya, right?

He said I want them to be one like you and I are one. So he doesn't just give his wish. He gives the wish and a model. And the model is mutual indwelling. Meaning all separation is an illusion. Whether it be between God and man, man and God or man to man, right? All separation is an illusion. So he wants us to be one like he and the father are one that they might be one in us. So he's reconstructing, he's re-heading, recapitulating this delay and division only

to bring us to the next scripture which is where I'll close today. You ready? And the glory which you gave me, I have given them that they may be one just as we are one. I in them, you in me, that they may be made perfect in one.

Yes, sir. Man, that's good stuff. Man, that's good stuff. Quick review. Adam can't glorify the Father because he's wrong about him. He's a false witness. What's it mean to bear false witness? 4,000 years of it right there. God has to have his name glorified in the earth. It's the one reason the incarnation happened. If the incarnation can reestablish God's reputation on earth, then God becomes an authorized voice to redefine reality. So now the father glorifies the son, the son glorifies the father. Now the father is an authorized voice over you. So you get to be redefined right along with reality. So now your responsibility is to glorify God to creation by bearing much fruit. Yes. So you don't get the liberty of taking yourself out of this equation and asking God to glorify himself. He doesn't do that. That's right. Yep. Humans glorify him. Yep. Because he glorified them. Amen.

Part 4

Introduction to Doxa and Doubt

You got 45 minutes to quit that. Weavers, I was I had your names up to text you yesterday. Now I get to hug you all instead. Good morning. How are you? Good. I was talking to them. Ah, you guys ready? Good morning so far. Feels like we've been here forever. I have 7:30. That guitar was tuned. Go to 2 Corinthians chapter 3. Title of today's message is Doxa and doubt. Yeah, it's going to be good. I mean, did you did you think otherwise? All right, we're going to lay a foundation from 2 Corinthians 3. We are going to uh get into doxa and doubt. This is one of those messages that we're just kind of like cruise through.

You know, this isn't white water rafting. This is more like a lazy river kind of day because you really have to pay attention. Like you really have to see the detail and allow the detail to drown out the noise. Good. Okay. 2 Corinthians chapter 3. We'll start in verse 7. Say amen when you're there. If the ministry of death written and engraved on stones was glorious so that the children of Israel could not steadily look at the face of Moses because of the glory of his countenance which glory was passing away. How will the ministry of the spirit not be more glorious? If the ministry of condemnation had glory, the ministry of righteousness exceeds much more in glory. For even what was made glorious had no glory in this respect because of the glory that excels.

For if what is passing away was glorious, what remains is much more glorious. Therefore, since we have such hope, we use great boldness of speech. Unlike Moses, who put a veil over his face so that the children of Israel could not look steadily at the end of what was passing away, but their minds were blinded. Until this day, the same veil remains unlifted in the reading of the Old Testament because the veil is taken away in Christ. Even to this day, when Moses is read, a veil lies on their heart. Nevertheless, when one turns to the Lord, the veil's taken away, and the Lord is spirit. And where the spirit of the Lord is, there is liberty. But we all with unveiled face behold as in a mirror the glory of the Lord are being transformed into the same image from glory to glory just as by the spirit of the Lord.

Can I pray for you? Can I pray with you? Father, thank you so much for these beautiful human beings. I'm asking right now that this place be an open heaven, not just legacy new Philly. Angels ascend and descend. Spirit move to and fro. execute the commands of the recipients of salvation. Bring healing, deliverance, wealth, increase, and revelation in Jesus name. Everybody said, "Amen." All right. So, I want to hone in on something here. Um, there is a causal relationship with truth. Truth causes boldness. Truth causes boldness. And I want to try

to put everything in the universe into a little box so that we can understand the crux or the foundation of fear, doubt, anxiety, relational issues, everything that you encounter that is anti-heaven exists for one reason and one reason alone. And it's because there's no duality in the kingdom.

Understanding duality and faith

There's no duality in the kingdom. There was a teacher that tells this story about the uh the handball champion. You know what handball is? Yeah. It's like tennis for somebody that can't afford a racket, I think. I'm just kidding. I've never played it, but it seems a little archaic when we've got these, you know. But anyway, handball. Do you know the guy uh that previously held one of the the the champion titles had one hand? Yep. And in in an interview he said, "How do you win at such a detriment?" He said, "I don't have a detriment while my opponent is deciding which hand they're going to use." Yep. I have my mind made up. Yep. So the reason that he excelled was what looked like a detriment to him, choice, became his strength.

You have to get rid of choice. We're really bad at forensically pulling these definitions apart and we think that that there is either good or evil or there's either faith or fear, or there's death and life. Those commodities, those luxuries aren't afforded to us. It's way more complicated than that. You don't have to be part of a death cult to not experience life because the message of the kingdom and the message of the Pharisees are both like leaven. Which means if there's a little bit left, it'll ruin the whole thing. If there's a little bit left, it'll ruin the whole thing. So, we have to stop looking for absolutes, begin looking for duality, and realize that duality is the source of all of our dysfunction, right?

Yes. If divorce is still on the table in your marriage, plan on it. I married a Viking. They burn boats. Yeah. Right. Yeah. They burn boats. They get to the shore, they burn their boats. Guess what they're going to do? Win or die. And they're not good at dying. Yeah. So, my wife used to say, "Look where you're going 'cause you'll go where you're looking." Yeah. So, we need to begin to eliminate some options for ourselves because doxa is an opinion. And it's an opinion that you and I you and I can either submit to or submit to kind of. It's not submit to and or reject. It's submit to and possess an alternative. Yep. Are you everything he is? Absolutely. Are you nothing that he's not?

Yes. Those things are all true. However, if you still continue to allow yourself to be defined by your critics, then your critics will leaven your entire lump. Right. So while we are scanning the horizon for bears, parasites kill us. Get it? It just leaks. It's not a direct onslaught on your faith. It's just something reverberating in the background that's making sure that you never become absolutely convinced. You might be 90% sure it's not sure enough. Yep. So what what Paul

says in this passage, which is our framing passage for the whole series, the series by the way, it's called doxa. It's the word that we translate to the word glory in English. And it just means thoughts, opinions, or estimate. It's not some glorious or glittery word.

It just means what somebody thinks of something. So there is a glory of the old covenant and there is a glory of the new covenant. The old covenant judged according to sight. And you might think that sounds strange like we don't do that. Yes you do. Yes you do. Because it's not just sight concerning an evil person. It's sight concerning who their parents are. Do you realize why Jesus couldn't do any uh good deeds in Jerusalem? Because somebody spoke up from the back of the room and said, "I know his parents. His sisters are sitting with us." And then they immediately lost reverence for him because they humanized a son. They humanize a son. Get where I'm going with this? Right? So, there's a system where sight frames your reality.

There's a system where Christ frames your reality. Faith by definition is another word that there's no glitter attached to. Faith is the Greek word pistis which means absolute certainty of a thing. Right? Absolute certainty of a thing. So faith isn't glorious in itself. Faith is the certainty of something. And you can be certain of something you see and it's still faith. Get what I'm saying? Okay, so this is how Moses says it, right? He said, "For even what was made glorious had no glory in this respect because of the glory that excels. For if what was passing away was glorious, what remains is much more glorious. Therefore, since we have such hope, we use great boldness of speech." Get it? When do you use great boldness of speech?

When you're sure. Right? The way that you talk about something is an indicator of how you feel about it. Out of the overflow of the heart, the mouth speaks. So when your speech becomes bold concerning promises, your heart has it settled that what he says is true. Right? I'm not getting this out. It's just like It's not you, it's me. Right? Do you guys know where the word doubt comes from? It's a Latin word, dub. D-U-B, which is where we get our English word double. Old English word twēogan, which means two. So doubt isn't that you don't believe something. Doubt is that you think there's two possible outcomes. You understand why this is more important? Like therefore since we have such hope we use such great boldness of speech.

Right? So if we understand who we are, his doxa defines us. Then our interactions with God are confident. Shaking, trembling demonic response to the father. You guys didn't ooh enough for that one. Yeah. Right. Demons believe and they tremble. Right. All of the language concerning sons is we love him because he first loved us, right? That we might have boldness in the day of judgment. Therefore, we approach the throne of grace boldly for help in our time of need. Therefore, since we have such great hope, we use great boldness of speech. So, our interactions with the father aren't interactions of pleading like beggars. Our interactions are like sons that fully assume what they ask they receive. Yes. Get it? Yes. So what Paul is trying

to convey to this group in Corinth who had a lot of issues by the way is that there's two doxas and he's giving them that uh this reality that there's a doxa that's based on senses.

There's a doxa that's based on Christ and you can't commingle the two and expect to get results. James said that a double-minded man is unstable in all his ways. Then he said he shouldn't expect to receive anything. Isn't that strange? You with me so far? Yes. Okay. So, doubt double two. It doesn't mean that you don't believe something. It means that you believe there's two possible outcomes. Right? That really changes the way that things work in our soul. Like, I'm going to pray for this person to get well and they might. That's doubt. Right? God wants me to have all of my needs met according to his riches in glory. Better yet, he wants me to lend to nations and borrow from none. Yeah. Maybe.

No. Right? He became poor so I could become rich. Right? Not so I can become falsely humble and self-righteous and use poverty as a badge of honor. We get it. Yeah. Speaking of which, way to go on the dry bones thing. Yeah. Look, it says prophesy right across the bill of his hat. Yeah. Shout out to Tommy Green and Sleeping Giant, by the way. Yeah, if you listen to him, you probably won't like them, but I love them. I love them. Okay. The word doubt owes its silent B to the root dub. Both doubt and double have the dub root prior to borrowing the French doubt and doubter. Old English had the word twēogan which means to doubt or to hold two opinions at once.

The modern the modern term doubt and double have the same sense of twoness consisting of two equal identical similar parts or things twice as much twice as many. Doubt and double have a b and a root that means twoness. Now, this is why it's really important to pay attention when Jesus uses the word doubt. Right? Oh, you have little faith. Why did you doubt? Right? Doubt is like leaven. Doubt isn't anti- anything. Doubt is an addition to, right? Doubt is when you haven't burned your boat yet. Doubt is when divorce still comes out of your mouth. Doubt is when death still comes out of your mouth. Doubt is when poverty still comes out of your mouth. There's no other outcome for sons other than Christ.

Yep. Good. So, how about this? I almost titled last week's message saved by an opinion. Thought I'd get in too much trouble because everybody that critiques me doesn't actually listen. But in reality, isn't that what happened? Yeah. And faith, glittery word, we could just reduce that to certainty because that's what it is, right? And you were saved by grace through faith, right? So, you were saved by certainty and an opinion. Yeah. Right. And if you want to bear the fruit of that opinion, because you weren't saved by your faith, that's the really important thing to understand. You were saved by faith that wasn't yours. So Jesus's certainty saved you. And if you would like to align yourself with the reality of that doxa, then he gives you that doxa.

But you have the opportunity to falter between two opinions. Do you guys remember Elijah in First Kings 18 when he's about to throw the uh the sacrifice on the altar? He calls out to to to God's people and he says, "How long will you falter between two opinions? If God's God, serve him. If it's Baal, serve him." Then he says, "Better yet, let's find out. Let's put a sacrifice on the altar and see which one God falls on." It's messianic prophecy. Let's put a sacrifice on the altar and see which one God falls on. Yeah. So, he confirmed glorified himself in his son by raising him from the dead. So that we know that what the son said about the father is true. So what the father says about you is true.

So you can be glorified in the father. You can be validated. Right? You want me to give you another one? Just I won't even take up a second offering for this one. Doxa is glory. Doxazō is glorified. The same family of Greek terms is the one that we I hate this translate justified. The moment you hear justified, you see a gavel, you see a cloak, you see a bench, and you're acquitted of all charges, right? That's not at all what justified means. Justified. You ready for this? Means means vindicated.

Overcoming obstacles through faith

Listen, listen. Here's the definition of vindicated in that in in in the Greek text is confirming with evidence so that someone is thought of the way they desire to be. Wow. That's not cosmic. That's human to human. God will vindicate you. God will bring the fruit of your life to a place where people say about you what you want to be said about you. Yeah. He's a beautiful God, right? He's a beautiful God, right? How how often like I'm justified. Justified. Never sin, right? It's not true. You're vindicated. Meaning everything you ever wanted to be considered, you are right. Okay, let's talk about this then. I've got so much here. Uh, go to Matthew 17. Do you want to go to Matthew 17? You just want to go?

Nah. I always ask my wife if she wants to go and she always goes, "You want to lose? 20 years. 20 years. I'm like, you want to fight? She's like, you want to lose? Okay. Matthew 17. Ready? Man, where do you want to be? Let's go to verse 14. When they had come to the multitude, a man came to him kneeling down and said,"Lord, have mercy on my son. He's an epileptic. He suffers severely, and he falls into the fire and into the water. So I brought him to your disciples." And they couldn't cure him. Then Jesus answered and said, "Oh faithless and perverse generation, how long shall I be with you? How long shall I bear with you? Bring the boy here to me."

Jesus rebuked the demon. It came out of him, and the child was cured from that very hour. Then the disciples came to Jesus privately. Here's the the number one hermeneutic that you need for this passage is the scene changes. It's really important. The scene goes from being

centered around a demon to being centered around another exegetical subject. That exegetical subject is no longer a demon. Because everybody's like Jesus is about to say, "This kind only comes out by prayer and fasting." Yeah. There's no demons that have special weapons that need brought down by prayer and fasting. So the exegetical subject changes, right? So Jesus, excuse me, the disciples come to Jesus privately and say, "Why couldn't we cast it out, right? And then Jesus says, if you would have like flicked it this hard, it would have flew to the moon."

Like that's the kind of language he's trying to use. He's not trying to use something like inconspicuous or vague. He said, "If you have faith the size of the mustard seed, you can move a mountain." What he's trying to say is faith isn't the problem, sir. Right? That demon stood no chance. All it would have taken from you, but you couldn't cast it out because of your unbelief. Your unbelief, which the word is apistia, right? It's not opposite of faith. It's an addition to. It's holding two opinions at once. So, I I really don't like these. Some sometimes they're incriminating and indicting. don't like reading this passage ever. But Jesus, when confronted about why they couldn't do something, he's like because you still had two options.

You still had two options. However, and this isn't what this teaching is about. He said this kind comes out by prayer and fasting, right? So, if you have and and here's the here's the important thing, invisible ceilings of unbelief. Unbelief isn't something that sons consciously carry around, right? Unbelief is usually subconscious and it's programmed through senses and experience. So it's not it's it most of the time you pray for somebody like what the heck, right? So invisible ceilings of unbelief come down through the affirming practices of prayer and fasting. Prayer and fasting aren't works. Prayer and fasting are expressions of sonship. If you believe prayer and fasting are works, then the confession is that you're not the species that likes to eat word in communion with your dad.

Right? You can turn fasting into a work if you do it to become something rather than do it to reveal something. With me? Okay. So Jesus rebuked the demon. It came out of the child and he was cured from that very hour. Then the disciples came to Jesus privately and said, "Why couldn't we cast it out?" So Jesus said, "Because of your unbelief, assuredly I say to you, if you have faith as a mustard seed, you'll say to the mountain, "Move from here." and it will move and nothing will be impossible for you. However, this kind does not go out except by prayer and fasting. Good. Okay. So, we've got a lot of this to cover, but I really don't want to move past the practical.

The practical is you guys know who Leonard Ravenhill is? Leonard Ravenhill wrote a book called Why Revival Tarries. And um it I mean it's very traditional just so you know, but passionate. One of the quotes in there, it says that uh the church is busy fighting mice while

lions devour the kingdom. And I think he's actually wrong. I think we're busy fighting lions while mice devour the kingdom. Because I think the trouble is actually in the nuance, not in the obvious. Right? The trouble is in the nuance, not in the obvious. So while something might be blatantly evil, the word evil in the New Testament just means laborsome. So if something is works based, we're translating it to evil. So it might not look like death, but it might produce death because it's righteousness trying to become something, right?

And doubt, doubt is nearly impossible. There's nothing in the world that doubts as far as we're concerned. Demons don't even doubt. They believe and oppose. Right? So, we're looking for a posture that really doesn't exist in anything. We're not looking to produce an opinion that is in line with his. We're looking to eradicate anything that was birthed into us through evidence that contradicts. Right? This kind comes out by prayer and fasting. It doesn't say that you build up something. As a matter of fact, building faith is impossible. You weren't saved by faith and nobody musters up faith. It says that he dealt to each one a measure of faith, and if you have this much, You can move a mountain. So faith's never the issue. Right?

So, what I'm what I'm trying to say is that all of the things that are plaguing you right now are probably because you've given yourself options, right? Probably because you're giving yourself options. And I'm not like what I'm talking about are things that are within your control. So, are you anxious? Maybe. Do you know what anxiety is? Fear of something other than your expectation happening, right? Two opinions. Yeah. The best neuroscientists in the world say that depression can be cured, not helped, cured in 21 days.

Spiritual discernment and truth

After 21 days of focused thought on gratitude and positivity, neurogenesis will train all of your brain cells to be happy. I'm not a doctor, but I married one. So what I'm saying is you may have given yourself a choice, right? And here's the beauty of it. Sometimes the the reconciling these things means if you thought yourself into it, you can thought yourself out of it. I knew I used the past tense when I didn't mean to, but it sounded more clever. Um, Lynn Hiles, if I had a nickel for every time I heard that guy say, "Eat mo' lamb. Eat mo' lamb." We ate ourselves into this problem, we can eat ourselves out. The way that humanity came into bondage was through eating of the fruit.

The way that they get out is through eating the lamb. Eat mo' lamb. Right? So, the way you get in, it's the way you get out. Okay? So, I don't know if this is getting there the way that I need it to. Right? Anger is a choice. Anger's a choice. You can be plagued by anger at the hands of people that don't even think about you when they go to bed at night. Yeah. You're not even on their mind. Yet your life is ruined because you gave yourself a choice. Yeah. Your marriage is

on the rocks. Shannon and I were almost divorced weekly for 3 years till we met Jesus and we realized it's not an option, right? If it's not an option, guess what all of a sudden starts to happen?

Makes it work, right? This is another reason why you need we need the globe needs a positive view of the future. Because if you think God's coming to blow this thing up, I promise you're not going to fix it first. Yep. The priesthood of Jesus Christ was perfect because of the power of an endless life. It's Hebrews 7, right? So why would you keep trying if you plan on rapturing? We good? Okay. Oh, go to James 1. You know faith has an enemy. Do you know what it is? Huh? Uncertainty. No. Sight. Yeah. When they're held in contrast biblically, the just walk by faith and not by sight, right? So sight is the enemy of faith. It's a big deal, right? Doubt's not the enemy of faith. Doubt is produced by what you see.

Good. Where did I tell you to go? James 1. I should join you. James 1. We're going to be somewhere around two. Let's start in two. Brethren, count it all joy when you fall into various trials. How would you like if somebody gave you that advice? Okay. Like I said that as a joke, but now I think it's real. Um uh this church was formerly uh led by Stephen. So these people that are getting a letter from James are the dispersed because their apostle was just violently murdered. So, their church fell apart. Apostle was murdered. And Steven's overseer decides to say, "Hey, it's not that bad, right?" Shand uh she always quotes that song, I just want to be mad for a while. You know, yeah, they were not given that luxury.

He said, "My brethren, count it all joy when you fall into various trials, knowing that the testing of your faith produces patience. Patience will have its perfect work that you might be perfect and lacking nothing. If any of you lacks wisdom, let him ask God, who gives to all liberally without reproach, and it will be given to him." Ready? But let him ask in faith with no doubting. For he who doubts is like a wave of the sea driven and tossed by the wind. Let not that man suppose that he will receive anything from the Lord. He's double-minded and unstable in all his ways. Right? These are really indicting passages. But he's not indicting us to to to bring us to a place of shame.

He's he's instructing us to pull us out of a place of defeat. I can say it right now without hearing de hands because you went to the bathroom. He's instructing us how to not keep being tossed by the waves, right? This is this is the the the connection that we need to make. Jesus, when he's speaking to Nicodemus in John 3 and he's explaining what it means to be born from above, he said, "People that are born from above, they're like the wind. Don't know where they came from, but you can see their effect, right? James is saying that if you're double-minded, you're like the wave, right? Waves have no control over where they go because something else is controlling them. Wind is controlling them.

So, James and Jesus aren't using these two illustrations haphazardly. They're using these illustrations in tandem to let you know that you can identify as one or the other. If you're double-minded, you'll be like the wave. Which means how big you are, how small you are, where you end up is completely dependent on something outside of you. If you identify with the risen Christ, the one that gives breath to all creation, then you're no longer of creation, being pushed around by something invisible. Now you are one with the life-giving spirit that tells those waves where to go. Right? We good so far? Huh. Where do you want to go now? Matthew 21. I don't want to go to Matthew 21. Skip that. James 2. No, don't go there either.

Uh, 1 Corinthians 2. 1 Corinthians 2. I'm going to show you why modern Christian contemporary music needs evaluated. and we'll start. Oh man, we're going to have to start at the beginning. Now, let's go to six. However, we speak wisdom among those who are mature, yet not the wisdom of this age, nor of the rulers of this age, who are coming to nothing. Again, Paul is kind of going down that opinion route, right? We partner our speech with an intelligence not of this world. Then he says, "But we speak the wisdom of God," right? Verse 8, "which none of the rulers of this age knew, for had they known, they would not have crucified the Lord of glory. But as it's written, ready for this, eye has not seen, nor has ear heard, nor has entered into the heart of man the things which God has prepared for those who love him."

Do you know how many passages, excuse me, do you know how many modern worship songs are built on that? And this is a rebuke. Get it? Right? If you add melody and some chords to it, it sounds beautiful. But this is a rebuke. This is Paul again talking to this naughty Corinthian church about their carnal ways. And he's like, "Listen, it's not going to come through your eyes. It's not going to come through soul discernment. It's not going to come through your ears." Right? Next line. Ready? But God has revealed them to us through his spirit. So we use this passage to make God distant when it's actually trying to make God present. The passage is is meant to rebuke people that are using their senses to discern who he is rather than union to discern who he is.

Right? Faith has an enemy and it's not doubt. It's not demons. It's none of those things. It's sight. Eye hasn't seen, nor has ear heard, nor has entered into the heart of man those things that God has prepared for those who love him. But he has revealed them to us through his spirit. For his spirit searches all things, yes, the deep things of God. Ready? For what man knows the things of a man except the spirit of the man which is in him? Even so, no one knows the things of God except the spirit of God. This isn't supposed to sound distant, right? It's like saying, "I can spend as much time with Dr. Ricky as I as as a lifetime would allow and I would never know him.

I would infinitely and endlessly know about him. But until the two become one, I can't know him. Right? So he's like, who knows God except the spirit of God? Nobody can see him, hear him, nor has entered into the heart of man those things, but God has revealed them to us through his spirit because we're now one spirit with his spirit. So we don't have to doubt anymore. We don't have to live by what we see, hear, and feel. Right? For what man knows the things of a man except the spirit of the man which is in him? Even so, no one knows the things of God except the spirit of God. Now we have received not the spirit of the world, but the spirit who's from God, that we might know the things which have been freely given to us by God.

These things we also speak, not in words which man's wisdom teaches, but which the Holy Spirit teaches, comparing spiritual things with spiritual. Listen. Ah, the natural man does not receive the things of the spirit of God. They are foolishness to him, nor can he know them, because they're spiritually discerned. Okay, we got to we got to stop. Cosmic, not personal. He's not saying some people are carnal, some people are spiritual, some people don't get it, some people will get it. He's talking about you. He's talking about you. Your natural man will not receive the things of the spirit of God. Meaning if you're looking for evidence for affirmation, you will never get it because the search for evidence is the presence of doubt. The search for evidence is the presence of doubt.

Manifestation is the process by which you believe the process apart from the evidence creating the evidence. I can't I can't looking for evidence is the presence of doubt. It's the presence of an alternative outcome. So when he says, "Eye has not seen, nor has ear heard, nor has entered into the heart of man the things that God has prepared for those who love him," he's not saying, "You'll never get it." He's saying, "You're not going to get it that way." Adam thinks God's promises are foolish because they're free. How do we know he thought they were foolish? Because he wouldn't take them. He worked for them. Right? So, the natural man can't receive those things because they're spiritually received. But then, this is how he ends it.

This is what I love about Paul's ministry is he's willing to take a knife to the things that he needs to cut apart, but he always ends with truth. So, the last two uh verses of this chapter say, "But he who is spiritual judges all things, yet he himself is rightly judged by no one." Right? Let that one sink in. For who has known the mind of the Lord that he may instruct him? That's an Old Testament quote. It's an Old Testament quote that was a rebuke in the Old Testament that is is an encouragement in the New. Who has known the mind of the Lord that he may instruct him? We do, right? Let this mind be in you that was also in Christ Jesus that did not count it robbery to be called equal with God.

Right. Okay. I'm done for a moment, but not completely. What I what I really I don't I don't want this to be academic. I don't want this to be like, oh, now we know what doubt means.

What I want what I want to happen is for you to see that where duality exists, so does every evil thing, right? Duality exists anywhere that a process still exists. One more step, one more fruit to eat, one more prayer to pray, one more fast to have, one more whatever it is. Right now, the kingdom has something in it called polarity. It's not the same as duality. Dualism is when good and bad coexist. Duality is like God is expressed in male and female, right? Those two things together make up the entire expression.

However, if you analyze, if you articulate the things that you're currently struggling with, whether it be marital, health, relationships, then you may just have to realize that you're not the kind of species that treats your spouse that way. Peel it away. You may realize that you're just not the kind of species that's greedy and not generous. Peel that away to realize that you're not the species that lives in shame and condemnation. Peel that away. Doubt is simply the existence of an alternative outcome. It can be 1% of the thought of the outcome and it's enough to leaven the whole lump.

Part 5

Defining Doxa

Glory. Right. Two of you paid attention for four weeks. It's fantastic. The English word glory is one of the things that we've semantically saturated by saying it so many times without asking what it means that we just say it now to make ourselves look more Christian. Right. Somebody says something cool and instead of saying cool, you say glory. Glory. Right. Yep. And that's what makes us weird at gas pumps talking to normal folk. Yep. They're like, "Do you see my 21 ft Stratus with an Evinrude 150?" And you're like, "Glory, right?" Yep. Yep. You can't use normal words because you got to have some way to set yourself apart.

But the word glory in the Greek language is the word doxa. It's way less fun in the Greek language. But if you understand what it means, it unlocks something in the New Testament that is extremely imperative to you and I coming into the measure of the stature of the fullness of Christ. It means estimate, judgment, opinion, or view. So in John 1 when it says, "And the word became flesh and dwelt among us and we beheld his glory, the only begotten of the father." Most of the time what we picture is somebody walking through the marketplace in Jerusalem glowing, right? Way less cool than that, but way more profound. What Jesus was was God's opinion in flesh. Good. Jesus is God's opinion in flesh.

So what God thinks about you showed up as a mirror for you to look into so that all the the lies told about you previously fell under the government of an absolute truth that walked into time and space. Right? The next word that we visited was the word doxazō, which is the one that we translate into the word glorify, which again

Glorifying the Father

way less sexy, but way more profound when you understand exactly what it means. Can we go through the system real quick? For 4,000 years of this book, you have writings that when Jesus shows up, he begins to question. And if you've been in traditional church for any amount of time, your heart just skipped a beat. But one of the things that Jesus spends the most time doing is asking them to provide some kind of substance some type of consistent ideology through their adherence to the Old Testament. He healed a man on the Sabbath. He got in trouble for it. So he's like, "Are you trying to tell me that the Sabbath was made for man or excuse me, man was made for the Sabbath and the Sabbath wasn't made for man?

Are you telling me that if your ox fell in a ditch, you wouldn't pull it out because it's a holy day? As a matter of fact, some of the more profound things are when Jesus was talking to

followers of Abraham. He's like, I'm telling you the truth and Abraham didn't. Right. Or the law came through Moses, but the truth comes through Jesus Christ. So, he consistently sets himself at odds with our interpretation of the Old Testament. So what Jesus has to do is come in flesh to glorify the father because the father's voice has been lost in the earth. And because the father's voice has been lost in the earth, somebody needs to substantiate the nature of the father through incarnation because we're sensual people now.

You with me? Yes. So God uh intentionally keeps quiet after he gives the law on Sinai. You guys realize that he he penned the ten commandments into stone and then they put it in the ark of the covenant and after that there's no record of God's audible voice coming from heaven. No more. Right. Sometimes if you want what you say to mean something you have to say less. Wow. Yeah. Yep. God makes his words a rarity so that when he speaks, people finally tune in and say, "That's something we desperately need to focus on." So after he gives the commandments at Mount Sinai, the next time you hear God speak is when he said, "This is my beloved son in whom I am well pleased."

That's right. The word doxazō glorifies or glorified in English means to give evidence and substantiate the truth. So when God says this is my beloved son in whom I am well pleased, he's glorifying the son. And when you glorify the son, now the son's words become the authoritative truth in creation. So guess what the Son begins to do? glorify the father. He needs to set right the record of the god of the old testament so they don't see him as bloodthirsty, wrathful, and vindictive. They now need to see him as Jesus Christ the incarnate son has declared him right quoting scripture. I'm not making this up. No one imagine this. No one has seen God at any time except the one that has come down from heaven that was in the bosom of the father.

He has declared him. Right? So sometimes the the process of elimination means has Adam seen God? Has Zephaniah seen God? Has Jeremiah seen God? Also no. The Bible says, "No one has seen God at any time except for the one that came down from heaven that was in the bosom of the father, the monogenēs, the only beloved son of God. He has declared him." So, you're reading 4,000 years of text from people that never met the guy, right? The way that Jesus postures this text, I'm not anti-Bible clearly, like I chew these up like they're going out of style. But the way that Jesus postures it is that Jesus is the lens through which you interpret the Old Testament. You can't go into the Old Testament without Jesus as an interpreter or you will see it through a veil.

It says to this day when Moses is read, a veil lies on the heart. So this is what happens. I'm I'm going to I'm going to stop the review after this, but this is important. Jesus is glorified by the father, right? This is my beloved son in whom I am well pleased. Hear him. And then Jesus

spends the majority of his ministry now setting the record straight concerning his father. There's a very big reason for this. The reason is that we want the voice of the father to now be able to define you and I. And in order for that to take place, the father and the son have to be postured in our psyche as a credible witness. They're not credible unless they're glorified.

So the father glorifies the son. So the son can glorify the father. So the father can now glorify you. That's right. So that you can glorify the father. Your life is the living proof that the nature and character of the father is as it is seen in the incarnation of Jesus Christ. Right? So the false humility, the playing small stuff that you were brought up with, how many of you like before I before I started playing guitar at my own church, I was regularly told that heaven doesn't appreciate guitar solos. It does. It very much does. But there's there's this unspoken thing where to be a good Christian, you have to be nominal and mediocre or you're stealing glory from God, right? You're making it about you.

However, John 15 says, "By this my father is glorified, that you bear much fruit." So if people are going to see an accurate representation of the father, the father's not going to speak from heaven again. His glorification schematic has been laid out from the first century. The father glorifies the son. The son glorifies the father that we might be glorified in them. And by this the father is glorified that you bear much fruit. Meaning the things that are said about the father are affirmed as truth by you walking around in flesh. Good. It's a big deal. We've got another rendition of this this Greek text.

Vindication vs justification

Dikaioō. Easy to say this one. Don't like it much. Dikaioō. Okay. Probably never going to say it again. Yep. Just too many syllables. Strategizing my capacity this morning. If I'm going to miss some words, it's not going to be that one. Yeah, a few of you are rotten enough to understand where I was heading just now. Dikaioō, you ready for this one? Oh, you're not ready for this one. How many of you ever heard the English word used in biblical uh uh text justified? Okay, justified. We've got really cool t-shirts about it. Yep. Justified never sinned. Our understanding of justification is acquittal. Right? The evidence comes before the jury. The witness is there to condemn you and then Jesus steps in front of you and he is your justifier.

Right? The word dikaioō is translated in English to the English word justified. Terrible rendering of the concept because there is no English word there is no rendering of justified that's not judicial. And because we're looking at the New Testament text with a judicial lens, summary becomes our best guess. But summary means that you were guilty and you were acquitted. That layer of understanding that comes with that word insinuates that God had to take something bad and lie about it in front of a judge. Yep. If any of you have ever been

around a group of people where who you are has to be either inflated or lied about for you to be accepted, you know that there is no worse feeling than not being good enough to be told the truth about.

Come on, man. Listen. Yep. You with me? Justified is a terrible rendering of dikaioō. Vindication is the closest English word that we have for the principle of dikaioō, which is not that you take something that's guilty and make it innocent. It's you take something that's been lied about and tell the truth. Thank you, Lord. Much different, right? If you're honest with yourself, you're not after justification. Most of the time, you can't even find enough guilt in your heart to need justification. However, vindication is something that you regularly ask for because the antonym of vindication is accusation. Somebody just needs to come take my side, right? not lie about me so I look better in the in the presence of God, but vindicate me so that the things that have been done to me, said about me, heard about me are no longer the narrative that I have to possess.

Because when I walk into public, I'm afraid of what people might think. I don't want justified. Every rendering of the word justified in the New Testament is better placed as vindicated. Those whom he foreknew, he also predestined to be conformed into the image of his beloved son. Those whom he vindicated. He also glorified. Those who he dikaioō-ed, he also doxazō-ed. Those whom he came and told the truth about, he also affirmed the truth about them. Right? So he's not making up lies about you. This is what I despise. Hear me and maybe forgive me. This is what I hate about the grace gospel. Okay? The grace gospel is a piece of the gospel. It's not the whole thing. The grace gospel teaches that when God looks at you, he looks through the lens of his beloved son.

That means God has to lie to himself when he's telling himself about you. Right? And if you've been justified, that means that when he looks at you, somebody pleaded your case, threw away the evidence, and now the things that are true about you just aren't said about you. So, we're all just like winking. Like, no, he didn't. I don't remember that. This makes the whole New Testament narrative make more sense because when Paul says, "The things that I hate doing, I continue to do them. things that I want to do, I can't do. Therefore, I've concluded that it's no longer I that does it. Yep. It's sin in me. It's something else that dwells in me. So, the things that I've done that are contrary to the nature of Christ weren't me because outside of the nature of Christ, I don't exist.

Oh, man. You ready? You sure you're ready? I'll give you a few more and then we've got some serious business to take care of. This is weird today. I won't lie to you because we're not we're not reframing the way that the text is written. We're reframing the the way that the text has been presented for the sake of somebody that's in the cloud. You ready for that? 'Cause it's

brutal, man. It's brutal. Okay. How many of you have heard this text? I'm going to read it in a moment, but I want to start here so we can get it. No flesh will be justified in his sight. No flesh will be justified through the workings of the law in his sight. Right? When you use the word justified, what it sounds like it's saying is you can bring your works to God and he will not see you as just.

But how about this? No flesh will be vindicated by the works of the law in his sight. Better yet, the law will never tell God the truth about you. Amen. Amen. Your sins of commission, your sins of omission will never be used to create a narrative in the eyes of your father. The law can never vindicate you. The law will never present a truth about you. So the father has been actually questioned for his willingness to look at people that humans didn't think were worth it. Right? All of the texts that we quote and say that God's too lucky to look God's too holy to look on sin. I should have had more coffee. I'm glad I didn't finish that one either. God's too lucky to hold on sin.

Like God's too holy to look on sin. Right? So that was a prophet telling God that he's too holy to look on sin. And then he says, "So why are you like, you know, like so we quote the text out of the context so that we can get our justice against people that we might not like." But that prophet's like, "Why do you keep dealing with these people?" Yeah. God's not saying, "I'm too holy to look upon sin." He's like, "You know, you're pretty holy. You probably shouldn't deal with these folks. You and me, right? We got this. Yep. God gave that invitation to Moses. Yeah. He's like, "Hey, I'm going to kill all of them." Yep. All of them, bro. Like, our next slumber party will be two people.

Yep. You dig it? Moses is like, "No, God. Like, calm down. If you do that, everyone is going to think you're not good." God's like, "You know what? You're right. Let's keep them." you know. Yep. So, listen. No flesh will be justified by the works of the law in his sight. Meaning, no matter how many times somebody comes and pleads a case to him about you, he's like, "It's not true." Yeah. Yeah. And he reiterates this over and over. Have you ever heard this? This is so funny. We take these passages that are meant to give you the most freedom and they bring you into the most bondage because of the way that we've presented these texts, right? Have we not cast out demons in your name?

Have we not healed the sick in your name? And then Jesus will say, "Depart from me, you worker of iniquity. I know you not." Right? Do you know why he doesn't know them? Because he doesn't know them according to their works. Even if they're good. Yep. So if you come plead your case, God's like, "No, the working of the law will never tell me the truth about you. The truth about you is in me." Yep. Yep. Good so far. All right. This next one's going to be rough.

Jesus's ministry of truth

Ah, okay. Uh, dikaioō. The issue is that the English tendency is to make this a judicial word justified. Justified isn't a correct rendering of the Greek term. It's more intimate, personal, and weighty. It means to show, exhibit, evince one to be righteous. This is my favorite word right here. Such as he wishes himself to be considered. If any of you have ever cried out for vindication, it's when you've been falsely accused and you just want people to stop believing lies about you. Come on. Dikaioō is rendering evidence to someone's character that affirms how they wish they were considered. Better than justified. Better than overlooking your naughty things. Yeah. Yeah. No. No. No. If you understand vindication over justification, you'll realize that most of Jesus's ministry was spent in vindication.

Most of Jesus's ministry was spent in vindication. We found this woman caught in adultery. The law of Moses says we should stone her, but what say you? Right? What did that woman want right there? Did she want to be seen as an adulteress and stoned? Or did she want maybe did she maybe want people to see maybe why she was committing adultery in the first place? Maybe someone had stolen her value. Maybe someone had brought her up in that. Do you know there are some countries where prostitution is the single most noble profession that you can enter into? Because it's the only way that your family will jump a social class. So prostitutes are applauded in Thailand. Yep. So if you go there and you start hammering anyone that's selling their body as a business, then you'll have to figure out a way to support them. With me so far?

Yep. So, this little girl, human. Human. Listen. Somebody's daughter gets thrown at the feet of a pastor with religious people saying, "We just found her doing something naughty. We're allowed to throw rocks at her." But what do you say? Right. Vindication. I say, "What's true about her? apart from what she's done. And because I've been glorified, my vindication rings true. Yep. So, he proves, I don't want to go here too long because I talk about it all the time. He proves that that system's broken. The system of judgment based on sight is broken because then he says, "If you are without sin, you can cast the first stone." And it says, "They dropped their stones and left." Why did they drop their stones and leave?

Because they judge themselves according to their works. They could have been vindicated right along with her if they wouldn't have been under the system of sight. That's right. With me. Come on, man. So Jesus spends most of his time offering vindication to people who have been lied about. There's a leper that comes to Jesus. Do you know what the leper like in leprosy? You have no community. You have no family. You have no right to worship in a public temple. You can't shop in the marketplace. Yep. He comes up to Jesus and he says, "If you're willing, will you make me clean?" And then he puts his hand in his side. And then he

says, "I'm willing. Be cleansed." So he rewrites his story of unworthiness by touching him before he's clean.

Right? And you have to catch it because he didn't touch a dirty man. He touched a man that he saw apart from sight. Yeah. Way better. Right. He touched a man who had already been vindicated and then he gave evidence to his vindication in his doxazō, his glorification. Good. It's about to get way better. The father vindicates the son. The son reveals the father. Then Jesus publicly overturns false verdicts concerning humanity on a regular basis. The father established Jesus as a credible witness and the first thing he does is start using that posture to begin overturning false narratives for humans. How many of you wish people knew who you really were? And I want to make sure that I say this early. I'm not talking I'm not saying that you wish people would see you apart from lies.

Okay, that's one thing to be lied about. But it's another thing to allow your true past to define who you are now and then be perceived as that publicly. Right? He doesn't come to vindicate you according to the things that you've done. He comes to vindicate you according to the thing that you are. The things that you did weren't done by you. They were done by sin in you, which is how Paul teaches it. So those things were never meant to form an identity. So good. So he comes and he presents himself in human flesh. And then it says that you are transformed into the same opinion, the same glory by the um by the spirit, by the glory of the father, right? That you might see him as a mirror and be transformed into the same image.

Right? from glory to glory. Good, right? Okay. So, God's not coming to tell a story based on the truth about you versus the lies. God's coming to tell a story about you based on what he sees apart from your works versus what everybody else has conjured up according to your works. Good story, right? Okay. Almost there. This is tough. Vindication doesn't create truth. It reveals what has been true all along. That's the difference between vindication and justification. Justification comes to change the story. Vindication comes to reveal the story. Accusation and vindication are cousins. They're opponents in your narrative. Accusation is someone attempting to establish a story about you. Vindication is the authoritative establishment of what's actually true. Good. If the father has the final witness, accusation can wound your reputation, but it can't determine your identity. We good so far? All right. Go to Romans 3.

Romans 3 analysis

You guys want to know why I told you about our next sermon series? So, I have to preach it now. Yeah. Romans 3, we'll start in verse 9. Say amen when you're there. What then? Are we better than they? Not at all. For we have previously charged both Jews and Greeks that they are

all under sin. Ready? There's none righteous. No, not one. There's none who understands. There's none who seeks after God. They all have turned aside. They have altogether become unprofitable. There's none who does good. No, not one. Their throat is an open tomb. With their tongues they practice deceit. The poison of asps is under their lips whose mouth is full of cursing and bitterness. Their feet are swift to shed blood. Destruction and misery are in their ways.

And the way of peace they have not known. There's no fear of God before their eyes. Now we know that whatever the law says, it says to those who are under the law that every mouth may be stopped and the whole world may become guilty before God. Now, can I tell you how you're supposed to read this? Romans is the most succinct view of the New Testament gospel penned in your New Testament. The reason is that while Paul was in Corinth, he had an itinerary where he intended to go from Corinth to Jerusalem to Rome. You following me? While he was in Corinth, a prophet came to him and said, "Let me borrow your belt." And that prophet bound him hand and foot and said, "So shall it be when you go to Jerusalem."

This isn't a prop. I literally borrowed Ricky's belt in Dallas. Preaching reminded me. He's binding himself. All right. So Paul is in Corinth. His itinerary is Corinth, Jerusalem, Rome. He's told by a prophet that when he goes to Corinth, he might die. He might not make it to Rome. So what's he do? No, he writes a letter as though he's not going to make it there. Yep. So, the the the tact in reading this letter is that you have to zoom really far out because most people if they want to condemn someone, they pull the text from Romans. They pull the text from Romans because Paul takes a long time to say some things. But what he's trying to do between Romans 2, excuse me, 1 and three is make sure that we know that no works by anyone will ever tell your story to the father because everybody's got a reason why they're why they're qualified.

Like we're Abraham's kids. He's like, it doesn't matter. Then he said, but we're under the law. He's like, yeah, and you judge people according to the law. And do you not know, a wretched man, whatever you judge someone else for, you're guilty of yourself because the judgment of it makes you guilty of the very, very same. is what he says. He's like, "What about Gentiles are not under the law?" I said, "Yeah, they kind of are." He says, "They're under the law of their own conscience because whatever is a law becomes a law unto them." So, they're making up their own and it still condemns them and it'll still put them in a cycle of sin and death. Still put them in a cycle of sin and death.

Right? So, he takes three chapters to condemn everyone under the law. And then he uses their own text against them. This is really important. He's not telling the truth about him. He's saying, "Listen to what they wrote about themselves. There's none righteous. No, not one. Not

one understands. None seek after God. They have all turned aside. They've become unprofitable." It's like people that write this about themselves desperately need vindication. You're right. Here it comes. Ready? Now, we know that whatever the law says, it says to those that are under the law that every mouth might be stopped and the world might become guilty before God. Therefore, by the deeds of the law, no flesh will be vindicated in his sight. For by the law is the knowledge of sin.

Meaning the law didn't change the way God saw you. The the law changed the way you saw yourself. It's getting good, right? Ready? But now the righteousness of God apart from the law is revealed, being witnessed by the law and the prophets, even the righteousness, the righteousness of God through faith in Jesus Christ to all and on all all who believe. For there's no difference. For all have sinned and fallen short of the glory of God. All have sinned and missed God's opinion. This isn't about behaviors. This is about beliefs. Wow. Don't believe me? Look at what they write about themselves. Let's stop stop thinking theologically, start thinking personally, you'd probably write something similar. Yeah. If you take a collective record of your self-talk, if you let your AI wearable record you all day, it probably sounds a whole lot like this.

Yeah. And what this passage is saying is that that story never makes it into your father's ears. Come on. Right. Ah, even the Okay. For all have sinned and fallen short of the glory of God, that all might be vindicated, justified freely by his grace through the redemption that is in Christ Jesus. Yeah. Yeah. It's so good. It's just right here. Yeah. If you want to find death and legalism in this book, you'll find it. Yeah. Who was it? Brad Sax said, "The biggest doctrines of hate have been founded on red letters. Red letters and wrong hearts. You ready? Okay, we got work to do. Go to John 4.

The woman at the well

Oh my gosh, this is a good morning. Amen. I'm nervous about this one, though. John 4. How many of you have ever heard of the woman at the well in Samaria? Okay. What do you think of her? Yeah. What What's your traditional understanding? Traditional understanding of this hussy, right? Hussy. Photini. It's her name. This woman has a name. This woman is one of the first market evangelists of the New Testament. You ready? Verse one. Therefore, when the Lord knew that the Pharisees had heard that Jesus made and baptized more disciples than John, though Jesus himself did not baptize but his disciples, he left Judea and departed again to Galilee. but he needed to go through Samaria. We're going to stop right there for a moment.

Okay. There is a road called uh the Transjordan. The Transjordan is I think they said it's an extra 4 days. So if you're trying to get to Galilee without going through Samaria, you're going

to take an extra four days to get there by traveling the Transjordan. It's like when you see somebody that's kind of rough and tumble and you go to the other side of the sidewalk. It's like going to the other side of the nation so you don't have to go through their city. Okay? So he wants to leave Jerusalem, go to Galilee, but then he himself makes the declaration, we have to go through Samaria. And every religious leader at the time would have really taken issue with that. It's like saying, "We're going from home to church, but we have to stop at the bar first, right?

Or worse, you know, just leave that up to your imagination." So the first thing is that Jesus doesn't stumble upon you to vindicate you. He's on an active mission to vindicate you. Yep. And he will go to places that religious people wouldn't to make sure that people know the truth about you. Okay. Now, the text isn't the reason I'm bringing the text. The teaching is the reason that I'm bringing the text because somehow every time this woman from Samaria is talked about, we make up stories about her. This passage is literally about being vindicated from lies and we tell lies to make the passage more interesting. Wow. Yeah. Yep. And this this is a historical account of a woman named Photini that became a leader in the New Testament church that currently, as far as we're concerned, is in the cloud of witnesses for 2,000 years being told that she's a hussy across pulpits for 2,000 years.

So Jesus comes and vindicates this woman. She dies and goes to heaven. And the church begins to malign her again. This girl needs vindicated twice because we're so bad at accepting a grace-filled identity apart from works. Right. All right. So, Photini, right? So, he came to the city of Samaria which is called Sychar near a plot of ground that Jacob gave his son Joseph. Joseph's well was there. There Jesus therefore being wearied from his journey sat down by the well. My favorite part of this passage is that because he's a human, right? You see the son of man functioning in his humanity. His capacity is blown. He's tired. And he chooses to sit down by the well in Samaria. Right? Good so far. A woman of Samaria came to draw water.

And Jesus said to her, "Give me a drink." His disciples had gone away into the city to buy food. But the woman of Samaria said to him, "How is it that you, being a Jew, ask a drink from me, a Samaritan woman? For Jews have no dealings with Samaritans." Right? Good so far. So what kind of response does a trauma victim have to kindness? disbelief. Yep. My value's been stolen, sir. Why would you even talk to me? Yeah. If any of you know anything about trauma response, you'll be able to spot it in the text. Yet, we're willing to say that she's a hussy. Samaritans, for historical context, were people that were not Abraham's lineage, but wanted to be considered Jewish. and Jews would stay infinite distances away from them because they felt like they would be defiled by them because they were not Jews but they were pretending to be.

So they hated them. So this woman knew that if a Jewish teacher was there at her well that he must not know who she is or he wouldn't be talking to her. Good. Jesus answered and said, "If you knew the gift of God and who it is that says to you, give me a drink, you would have asked me," and he would have given you living water. The woman said to him, "Sir, you have nothing to draw with, and this is a deep well. Where are you going to get that living water? Are you greater than our father Jacob, who gave us this well and drank from it himself, as well as his sons and his livestock?" Then Jesus said, "Whoever drinks of this water will thirst again.

Whoever drinks of the water that I shall give him will never thirst, but the water that I shall give him will become in him a fountain of living water springing up into everlasting life." Jesus recognizes something in the pattern of a woman who's not been vindicated, and it's that pleasure lasts for a fleeting moment. And if any of you have not experienced vindication, you'll realize that pep talks only get you so far and then you start to believe what people say again. Yep. Usually Sunday afternoon feeling pretty good. Yep. Sunday night you start to question everything you heard. By Monday it's all over again for six days. So he's correcting the endless cycle of dissatisfaction that is finding your identity in the temporary because he's not talking about the well that comes from the bottom of that earthen vessel.

He's talking about the water that comes from him. And he said even if you dip down in that well and get what you need, you'll be back here tomorrow. Because as long as you're pulling your sustenance from something natural, you'll only ever be as good as it's going. And if you knew who I was, you'd ask me and I'd give you living water. And if you drink this, you'll never be thirsty again. As a matter of fact, you'll never live at the expense of another human again. It will bubble up in you and become a river of living water to others that need it, right? People that haven't been vindicated place the burden of affirmation on broken people that can't do it. Yep. With me so far?

The woman said to him, "You don't have anything to draw with." We read that, right? We're at 13. Jesus answered and said, "Whoever drinks of this water will thirst again, but whoever drinks of the water that I will give him will never thirst, but the water that I shall give him will become in him a fountain of water springing up into everlasting life." The woman said, "Sir, give me this water that I might not thirst nor come here to draw." Jesus said, "Go tell your husband and come here." Ready for this? The woman answered and said, "I have no husband." Jesus said to her, "You have well said, I have no husband, for you have had five husbands. The one whom you now have is not your husband.

In that you've spoken truly, right?" So, if if you're still reading this through really poor interpretation, are you are you staying with me? then you'll forget what opened this conversation. What opened this conversation was a woman saying, "If you knew who I was,

you wouldn't be talking to me." So Jesus asks her a question that causes her to tell the truth. Excuse me? That causes her to think maybe he doesn't know who I am. Right? Maybe he's in this conversation unaware. So he says, "Go get your husband." And he's like, "Ah, proof. Proof, right? I don't have one." He said, "I know you've had five. The one you have now, not your husband." Right? So, this is the text that everyone uses to justify maligning Photini's character like there's something wrong with her.

Yeah. Now, we've taught on this extensively, but if you haven't been here, I need you to know these things, right? The church has completely berated God's view of marriage and divorce. Follow me through this. It's really important, right? Because churches allow women to get beat and tell them if he didn't cheat, you can't leave. That's not at all the doctrine of divorce in your Bible. I'm not making this up. This isn't more progressive. This is exactly what your Bible says. Your Bible says in the law of Moses, there are two kinds of divorce. There is a certified divorce and there is an uncertified divorce. When the disciples asked Jesus why Moses allowed for divorce under the law, does anyone remember Jesus's response? Because of the hardness of your heart.

Because God needs to protect those beautiful women from jerks. That's why. So if you have a certified divorce, follow me through this. That means this is the law of Moses. If a woman shall not find favor in her husband's sight, she can request a certificate of divorce. That certificate is going to allow her to find love. She's going to present that certificate at the next ceremony of betrothal to explain why she's not going to be able to present a consecration garment. Amen. Okay. In the law of Moses, if a woman does not produce a consecration garment after they've consecrated the marriage, which is blood on a sheet, she will be immediately escorted outside the city and killed because it's evidence that she was impure and with with someone else before that.

Certified divorce means that you had a hard-hearted husband. God does not want you to have one. So, you get a certificate of divorce. You go find love and you say, "I'm not going to be able to give you a consecration garment on our consummation night. Here's why. I'm legal." Uncertified divorce is when you leave your marriage to go be with someone else. You don't get a certificate for that. That's why it says if you divorce and remarry, you're an adulterer. That's an uncertified divorce. That's being married to two people at the same time, right? So if you now understand the the theological background behind Photini's journey, if she were if she were what we say she is, she'd be dead. Okay? She's a Samaritan.

They practice Jewish law to a T. So if this woman would have been an adulterer, they would have killed her. Okay. So Photini is not an adulterer. Photini is unloved. And now she's got her fifth guy and she won't marry him. Why do you think she won't marry him? Would you?

Would you? She's been put away five times. She's been remarried with hopes that this will be the one. Five times and she won't commit to the sixth, but the seventh. Jesus is her seventh man. Jesus is her seventh man. and his interaction with her proves that he does know her. I I know you. It's not even prophetically. She said, "Go get your husband." That is his sly way of making sure that this poor girl doesn't leave thinking that he's just like the rest of them.

Go tell your husband. I don't have one. He's like, "I know you've had five and I still want to give you living water." Yeah. I know you've had five and I especially want to give you living water right now. This is brutal. You've had five husbands and the one whom you have now is not your husband and that you spoke truly. The woman said, "Sir, I perceive that you're a prophet." Right? You get me right? Our fathers worshiped on this mountain and you Jews say that Jerusalem is the place to worship. And Jesus said,"Woman, believe me, the hour is coming when you will neither worship on this mountain or in Jerusalem worship the Father. You worship what you don't know. We know what we worship, for salvation is of the Jews.

But the hour is coming, and now is when the true worshippers will worship the Father in spirit and in truth. For the father is seeking such to worship him. The the pivotal part of this isn't that it's saying they're worshiping differently. It's saying that we have a father now that is pursuing you. Yeah. The father's looking for those like they think they have to go to a mountain and he's saying you're not going to have to go to the mountain anymore. The father's going to chase you down. The woman said, "I know that the Messiah is coming who's called the Christ. When he comes, he will tell us all things." Jesus said to her, "I who speak to you am he." Right? At this point, the disciples came and they marveled that he'd even talked with the woman.

Yet no one said, "Why? What do you seek or why are you talking with her?" The woman then left her water pot, went her way into the city, and said to the men, "Come see a man who told me all things that I ever did. Could this be the Christ?" Then they went out of the city and came to him. In the meantime, the disciples said, "Rabbi, eat." But he said, "I have food that you don't know about." Right? Jesus said, "I've come. I've finished the work. I have glorified you." Right? So, he's literally talking about his very sustenance is to represent the father to humanity. To affirm his opinion to humanity. So, what he's saying is what I just did to that woman is why I exist.

I can't handle it. I can't handle it. So, let's tie this up real quick. The first thing that Jesus says is, "If you knew who I was, you'd ask me for a drink and then you'd never have to drink again. If you drink from this well, you'll be back here tomorrow." After this conversation, she throws away the very vessel that has left her in endless cycles of dissatisfaction. Because whatever she has received and recognized from that man, let her know that she never needs to find her validation in temporary and fickle and natural resources ever again. Yep. She doesn't have to

get enough likes. She doesn't have to have enough followers. Listen, here's the other thing that you really need to reconcile. It says that she came, does it say the ninth hour, sixth hour?

So, so it makes mention of that is because that's not when the women in the community came out to draw. Yeah. And if you reconcile that with the fact that she wasn't a promiscuous floozy, then you realize that she's just in isolation because she's afraid to get hurt, not because no one else will go with her. The irony is that this very story in its scriptural theology is a story of vindication. And then we overlaid it with maligning words and gave her a worse reputation through our preaching than Jesus took from her in the scriptural narrative. What does that say about our theology? Okay, I think I think I'm pretty pretty well done. Oh, we did we did we go to Romans 3?

Romans 8 conclusion

Okay. Oh, let's go to Romans 8 then. This will be this will be the last of it. Romans 8, we'll go to 31. Ready? No, no, no, no. We got to go back. Go to 29. Go to 29. For whom he foreknew, he also predestined to be conformed to the image of his son, so that he might be the firstborn among many brethren. Ready? Moreover, whom he predestined, he also called. Whom he called, he also vindicated. And whom he vindicated, he also gave evidence, doxazō, of that truth. Ready? If we said nothing else in this last 45 minutes, the next passage is all you need. What shall we say then? If God's for us, then who the hell else matters, man? Right? That's what he who did not spare his own son, but delivered him up for us.

How shall we not in him also freely? Excuse me. How shall he not with him also freely give us all things? Right? Who shall bring a charge against God's elect? It's God that vindicated. You can't you can't bring a charge against somebody that God's told the truth about. Amen. Come on. So good. Who is he who is who condemns? It is Christ who died and furthermore is also risen. Who is even at the right hand of God who also makes intercession for us. Who shall separate us from the love of Christ? Shall tribulation or distress or persecution or famine or nakedness or peril or sword? Let's stop there because these are the kind of things that try. These are the constant accusations to try to get you to believe a different narrative about yourself.

As it is written, for your sake we're killed all day, and we're counted as sheep for slaughter. Yet in all things, we are more than conquerors through him who loved us. I am persuaded that death or life or angels or principalities or powers, not things present or things to come, no height, no depth, no created thing, even your worst critic, shall be able to separate you from the love of God, which is in Christ Jesus our Lord. Is that good? Stand with me. Hot chick text me twice. Okay.

Prophetic prayer ministry

Yep. Okay. Shanda, would you pray for these people? Do you want me Do you want me to read it so it's on Okay. Come. I can't see these glasses on or off. These are ridiculous. Okay. Oh, for goodness sakes. It's I'm glad they're cute. That's all I can say. Okay. So, I I saw something and I'm also speaking with another prophet in the church here while I'm texting back and forth and they're telling me what they saw and I know what I saw. I saw um a couple in here. I believe they're in here today. I don't believe it's online. It could be. I don't know. I don't know. Could be more than one couple, but I saw a couple. And they were melded together like shoulder-to-shoulder almost like a flat picture.

And then a chunk was taken out of the middle where the shoulders meet like a Lego square. It's really really weird. I saw a chunk just taken out. I don't know what took it out. Uh I don't I don't know. I don't know. But then um and then my son writes he is seeing like a key or a phoenix in a web. I don't know if any of those things mean anything. I don't know. Um there's a couple in here that I believe a chunk was taken out. And there's some witchcraft about that took it. Something took it. I'm not and I'm not just saying voodoo witchcraft. There are all kinds of things that can take it out. But God wants to put it back.

And if you're willing to come up, God um specifically told me he's not going to spill your story and he's not going to tell what the chunk is because that's your business and yours alone. So it I don't even know what it is and I'm not to know. That's your business. Nobody in here will know your story unless you tell it. But if you want the chunk put back and you're a couple in here or if you're single and your couple better half is somewhere else at home or if they're in the gym or if they're busy or if they're working and you want to come up in their place, that is fine. I just want to let you know I see a couple and God wishes to replace that chunk and put it back with something good.

And I I would like you to pray for them and I just want you to. Is that all right? It's because I'm good-looking. Okay. if you want to come up if of course yeah of Yeah. Um is there am I don't I'm not off. I know I'm not I don't doubt myself anymore. There is a couple here. You with a hat. Can I come here a minute please? Holy cannoli. Eric dead on boy. Eric told me you he said you. Who's the guy in the hat in the center? Six rows back. That's you. Go. Come here. So, God wants to take something good for you. What is your name? Robbie. Robbie. Okay. You married? Okay. I'm not going to I don't My son is has a paragraph here.

I don't know. I'm going to let you read this. I don't I could I don't know if it's right or it was true of her name. I don't know. He's feeling just something there. I don't know what it is. It could be a chunk of something else. And you don't have to tell your story. You don't dude. You're dead

on. Dead on. Dead on. God has something very special for you. Okay. But I do want my husband to pray for you. I actually would like uh a couple. Jeff, please. You I I definitely need you to come up and there you are. Come you three, please come. Beep. Um you say Jeff? Yes, I did. Jeff, please. Jeff, will you come? And uh Trumans, will you both come, please?

Am I I might be missing anybody. I'm not really sure. But right now, um Eric, will you come? You can bring your wife. I don't know if your daughters need maybe they need babies yet. I'm not sure, but whatever you think is best, just come. I need you up here. I don't know. But Eric's dead on. Need you to pray. I'm going to stand up here. Okay. Oh, you don't need this. Okay. No, I wear mine. Oh, I forgot. Okay. So good. Yes. Thank you, Jesus. What a good word. I'm so excited for you. I'm so excited for you. I'm really excited for you. Yeah. Would you guys just reach your hands out towards Robbie? And uh first, thank you for the transparency in coming up. God doesn't point anything else out that he doesn't want to redeem. There's no other reason for it. Edification, exhortation, and comfort.